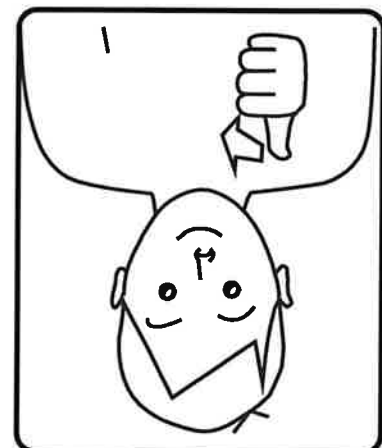


Tips of 'N' hand touch chin, then hand twists from wrist to point forwards.



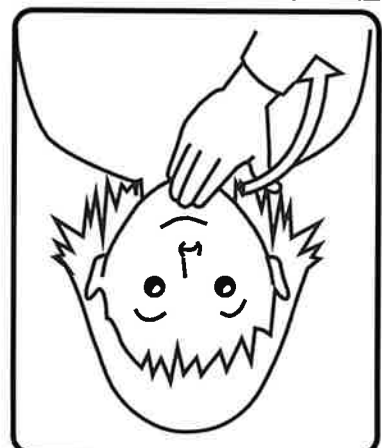
AFTERNOON

GOOD.
Closed hand with thumb up makes short movement forward. Two hands for VERY



GOOD

Tips of flat hand touch mouth, then hand swings forward/down to finish palm up.



PLEASE

Closed hand nods up and down twice.



YES

Finger-tips of R. bent hand (with thumb up) touch left then right side of chest.



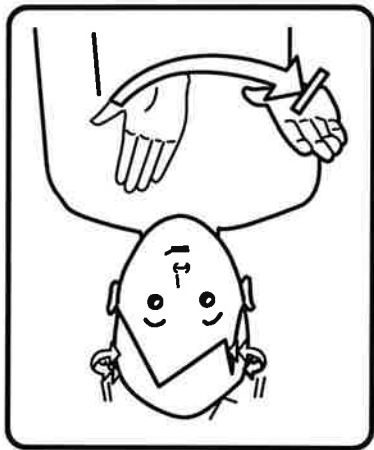
MORNING

Tips of flat hand touch mouth, then hand swings forward/down to finish palm up.



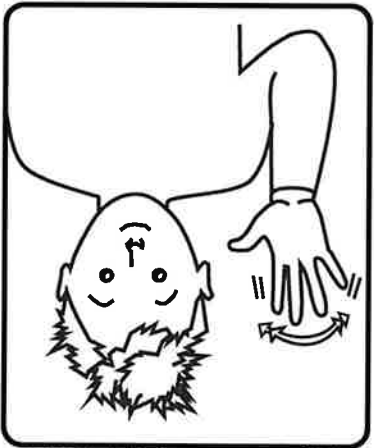
THANK YOU, THANKS

Flat hand swings emphatically to the right as the head shakes. Can be both hands starting crossed moving firmly apart.



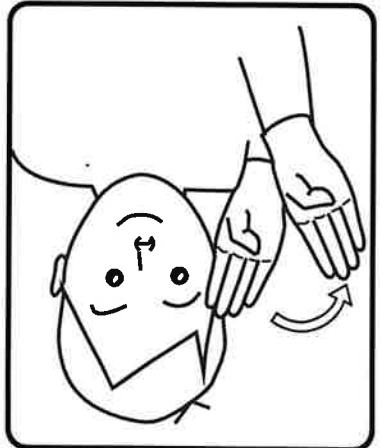
NO

Hand moves side to side in waving movement.



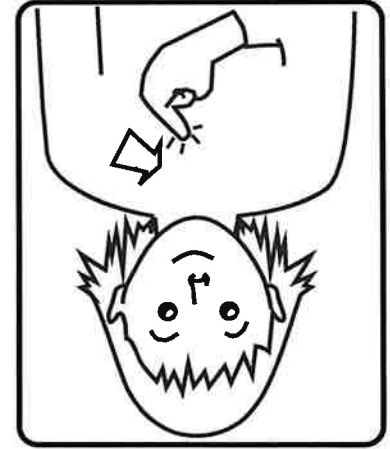
BYE, GOODBYE, CHEERIO

Flat hand with thumb tucked in makes short movement out from near side of head.

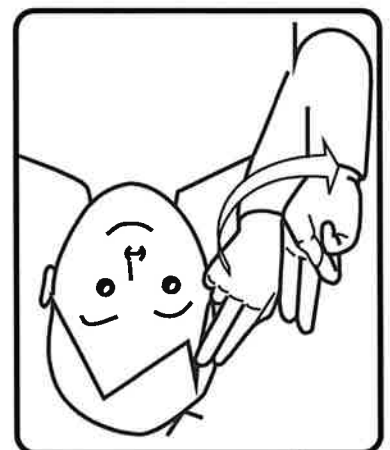


HELLO, HI

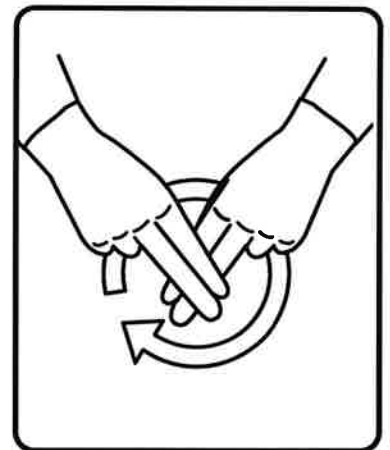
FAMILY/PEOPLE



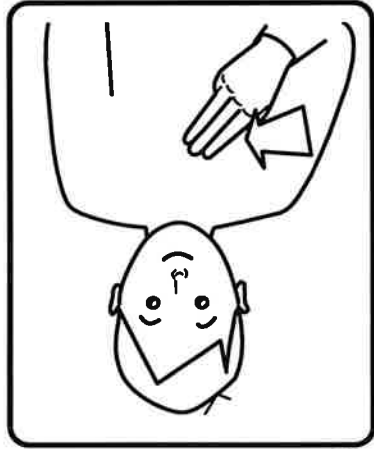
Tip of extended index finger contacts the chest.



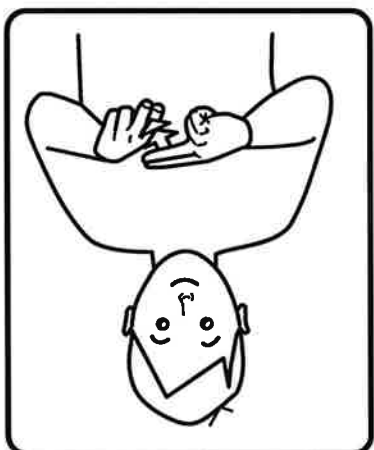
Tips of 'N' hand touch side of forehead, then move and twist forward.



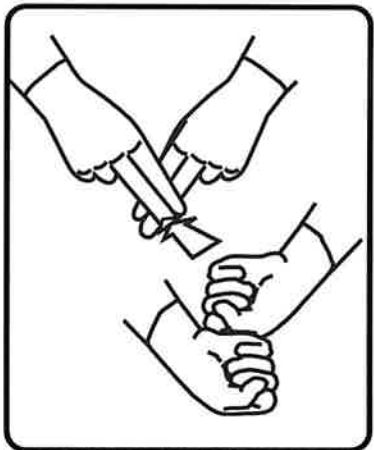
Hands form fingerspell 'F' formation and move round in horizontal circle.



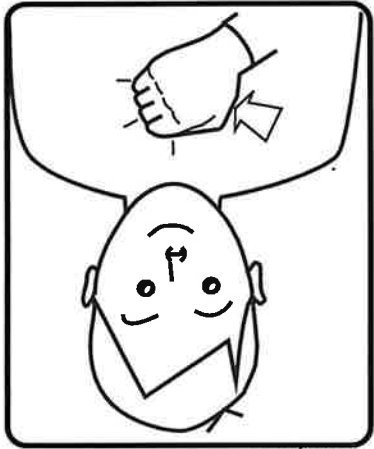
Fingertips of 'M' hand contact the chest. This is not a BSL sign.



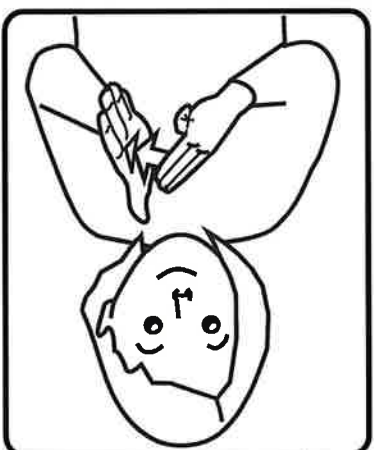
Fingers form fingerspell 'F' and tap twice.



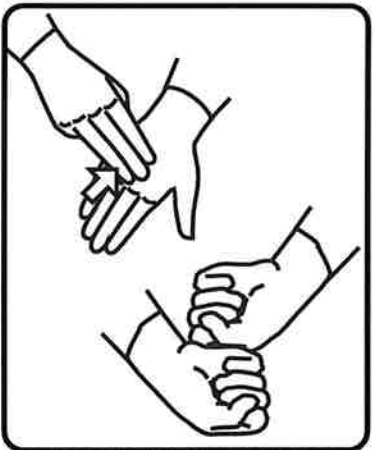
Fingerspell 'GF', GRANDFATHER, GRANDAD



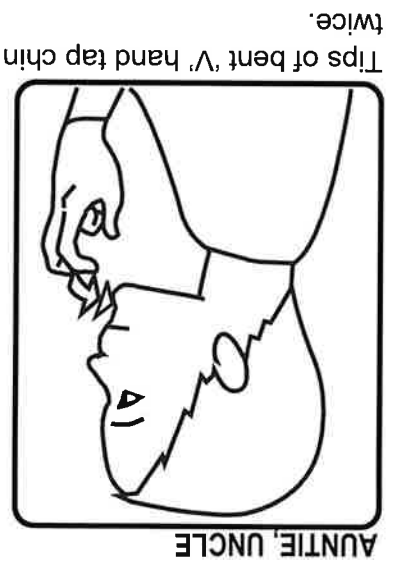
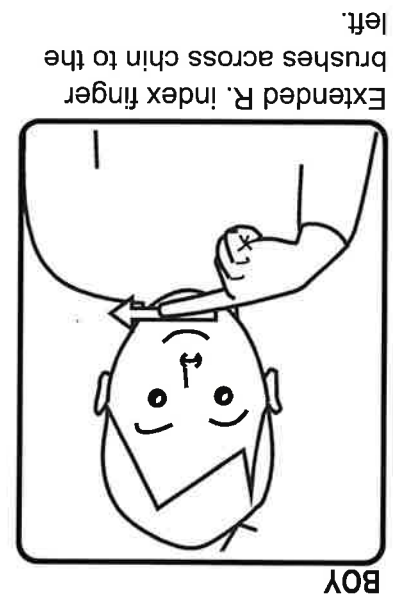
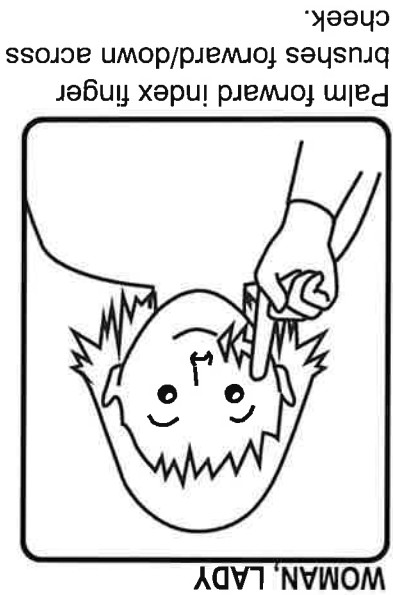
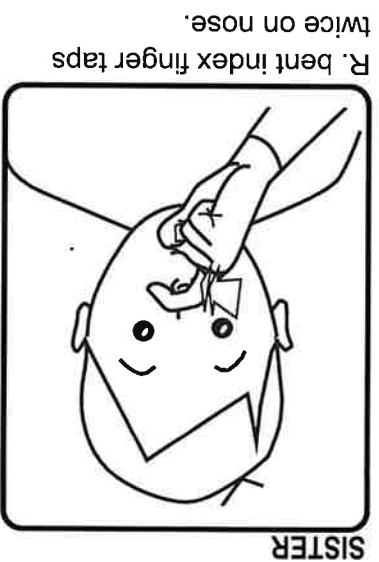
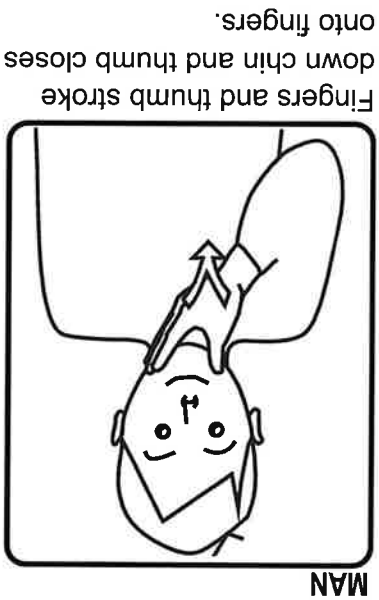
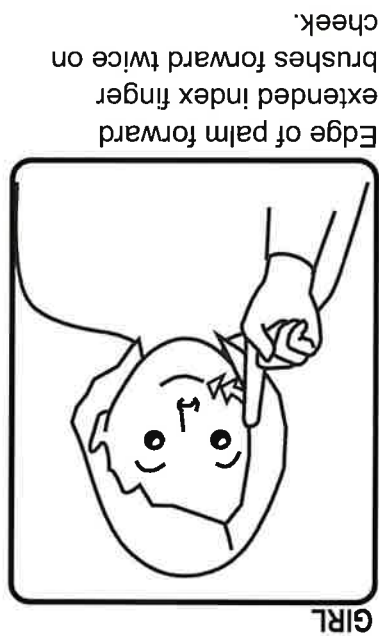
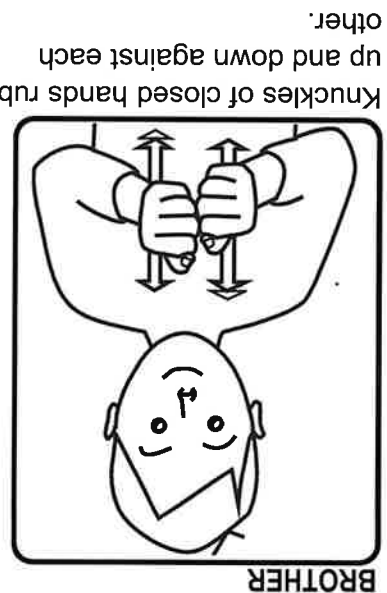
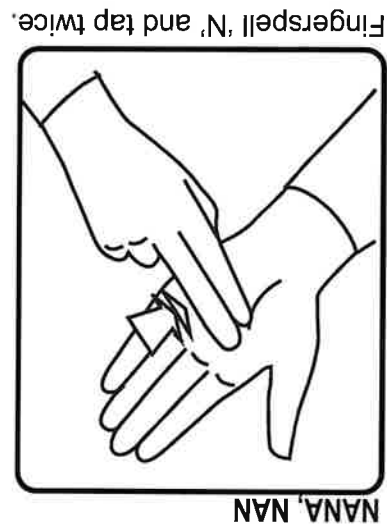
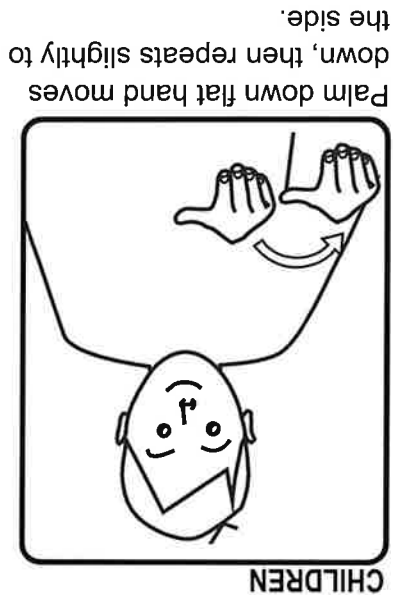
Closed hand moves back to contact chest.

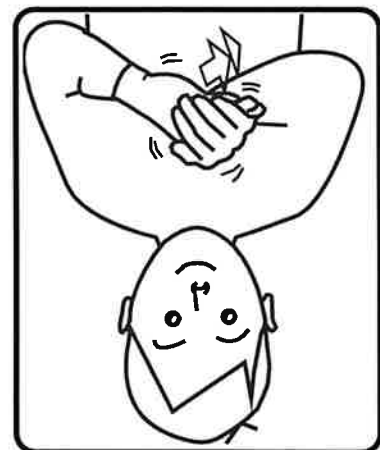


Repeated fingerspell 'M', MUM, MUMMY, MOTHER



Fingerspell 'GMM', or 'GM', GRANDMOTHER, GRANDMA respectively.





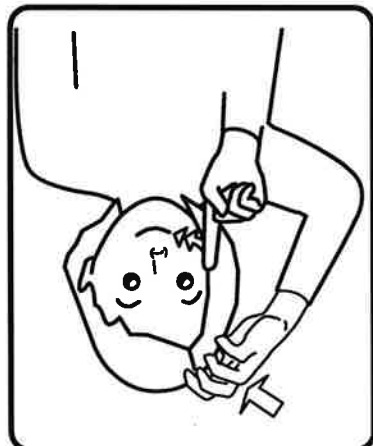
FRIEND



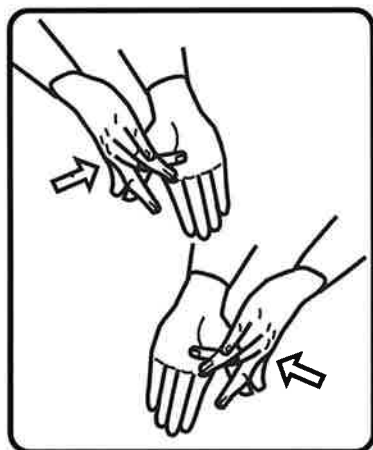
KING



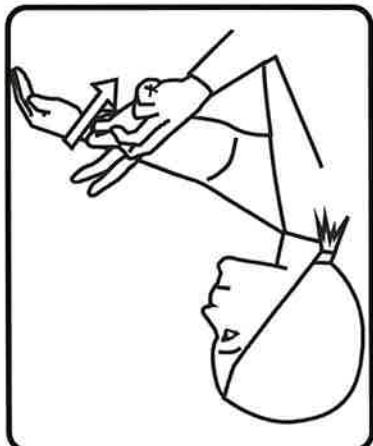
DOCTOR



QUEEN

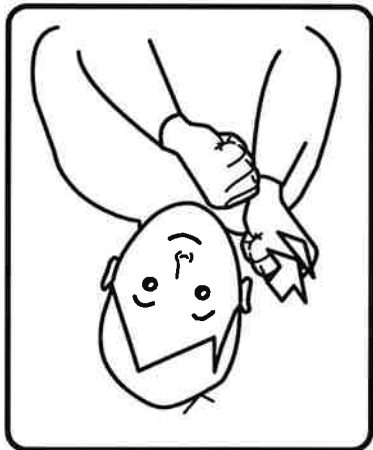


JESUS



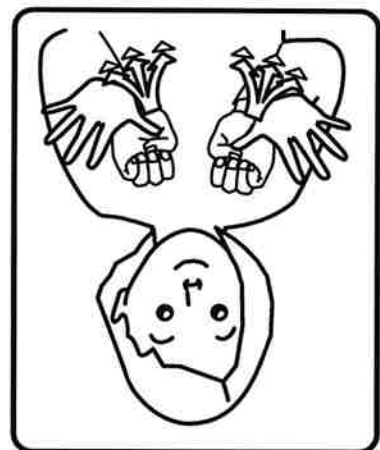
POLICE

Fingers of R. 'V' hand flex as hand is drawn across back of L. wrist.



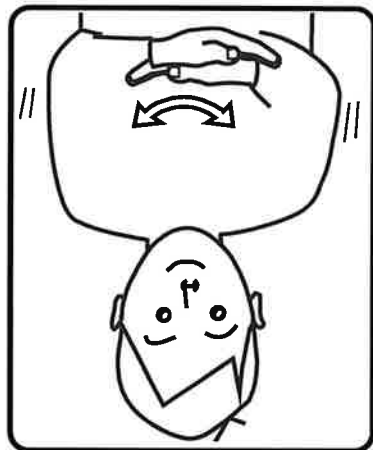
SANTA, SACK

Fists grip imaginary sack over shoulder with repeated up and down movements.



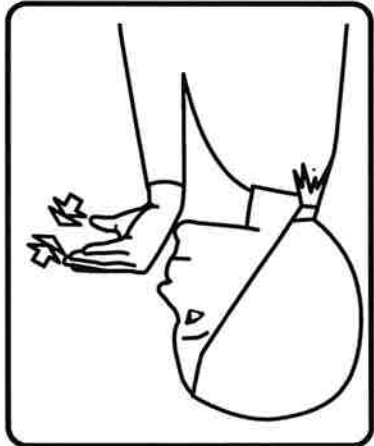
MAGIC, MAGICIAN

Palm forward full 'O' hands spring forward and open twice.

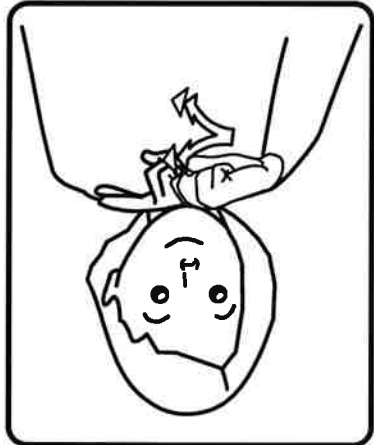


BABY

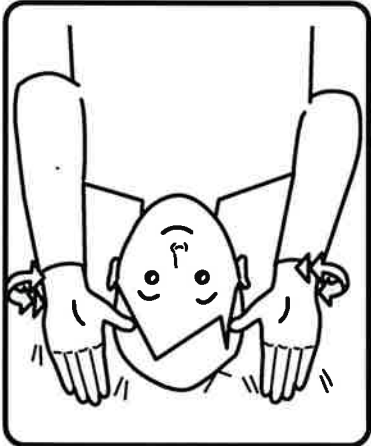
Arms move from side to side in rocking movements. Without movement for DOLL.



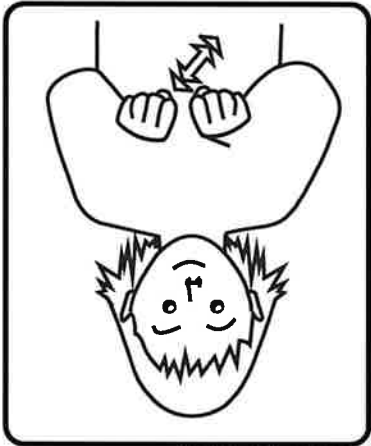
DUCK



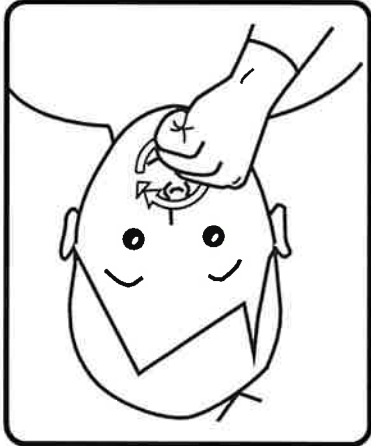
FROG



DONKEY



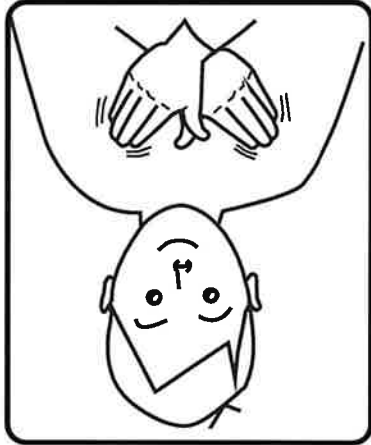
HORSE, PONY, RIDE



PIG



HORSE



BUTTERFLY

Fingers of bent hand (or 'N' hand) open and close onto thumb several times, in front of chin.

Full 'O' hands move upwards and outwards from the sides of the forehead in shape of horns.

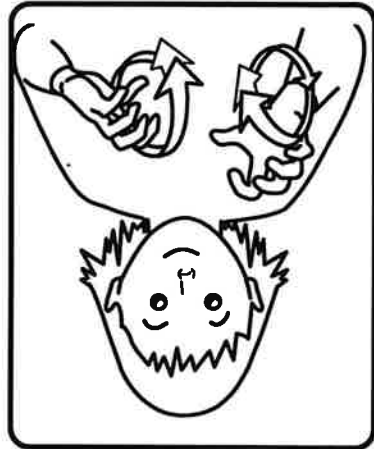
Thumbs of flat hands contact sides of forehead and hands twist from wrists several times.

Palm down closed hands make repeated movements forward/down.

Fist moves round in small circles in front of nose.

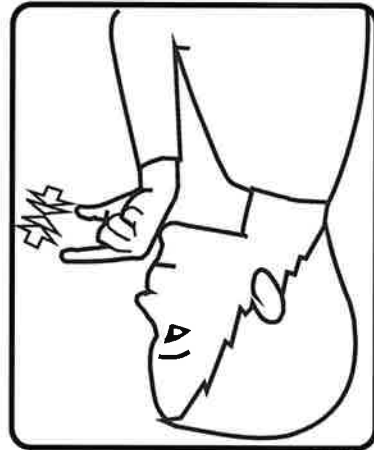
Fingers of R. 'V' hand are placed astride L. flat hand.

Hands are crossed with thumbs interlocked, and hands bend from wrists in flapping movements.



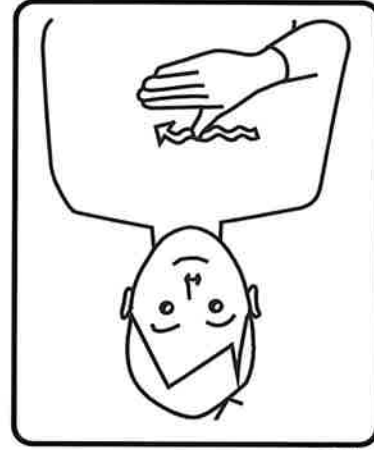
ANIMAL

Clawed hands make repeated alternate forward circular movements.



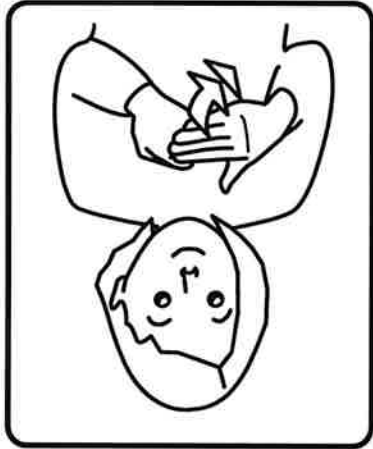
BIRD

Index finger and thumb open and close in front of mouth. Elbows may move in and out (CHICKEN).



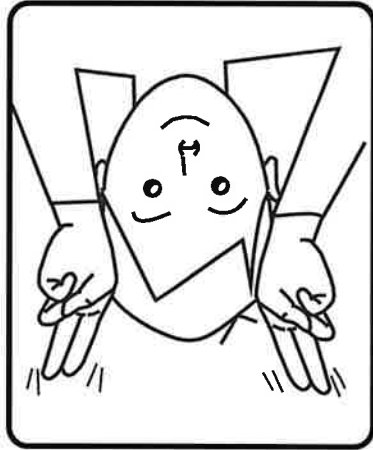
FISH

Flat hand moves diagonally forward with quick wiggling movements from the wrist.



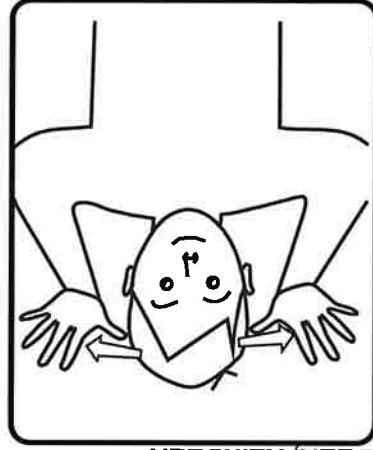
PET

R. flat hand strokes back of L. closed hand.



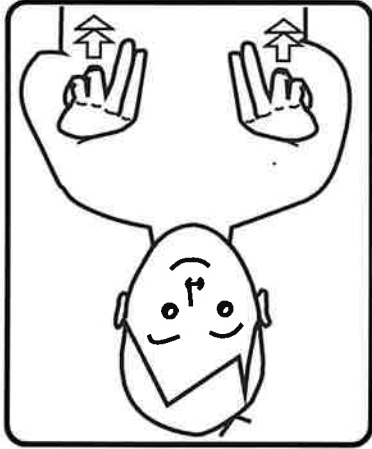
RABBIT

Palm forward 'N' hands held at sides of head twitch forwards several times.



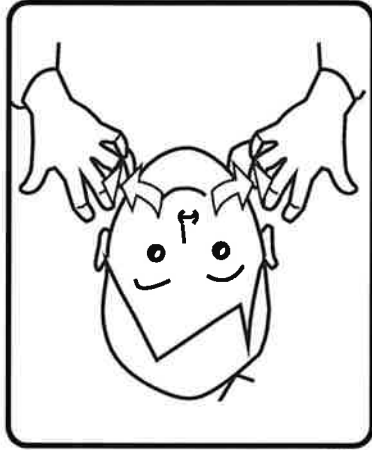
DEER, REINDEER

Thumbs of open hands on sides of head; hands move slightly forward and apart.



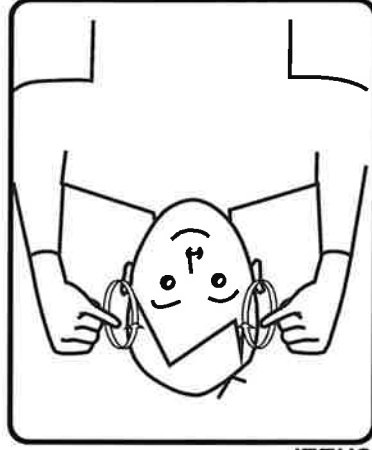
DOG

'N' hands are held like a dog begging, with two short downward movements.



CAT

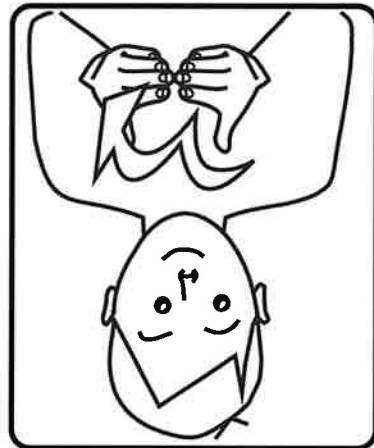
Fingers flex as hands make short repeated outward movements from sides of mouth.



SHEEP

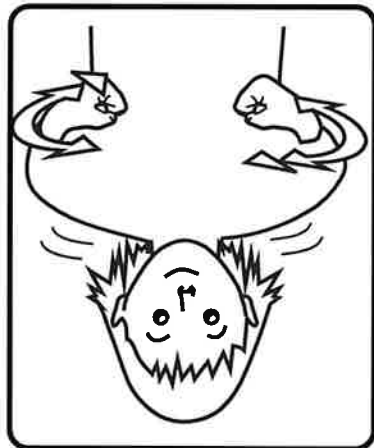
Extended little fingers make forward circles from sides of head.

Tips of flat hands touch, forwards held at an angle move forwards in up and down bobbing movement.



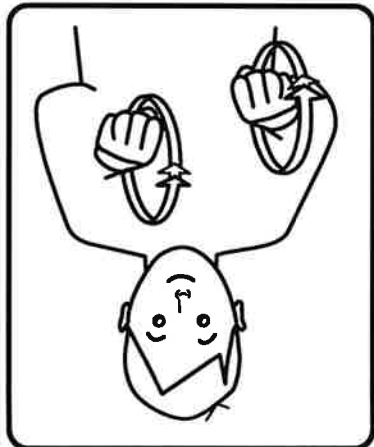
BOAT

Palm up fists make forward and back steering movements as body and shoulders shake up and down.



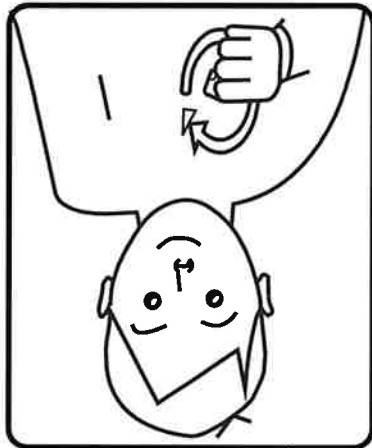
TRACTOR

Closed hands make alternate forward circular motions.



BIKE, PEDAL

Closed hand (or fist) makes forward circular motions at side of body, or single firm movement forward.



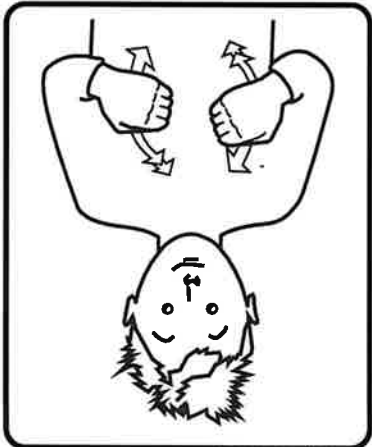
TRAIN, RAILWAY

Closed hand with thumb and little finger extended moves in action of a plane flying.



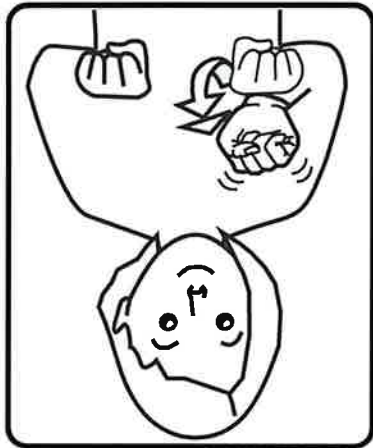
AEROPLANE, FLY

Closed hands move in action of holding and moving a steering wheel.



CAR, DRIVE

Both hands in fists are held palms facing down; R. hand twists upwards twice.



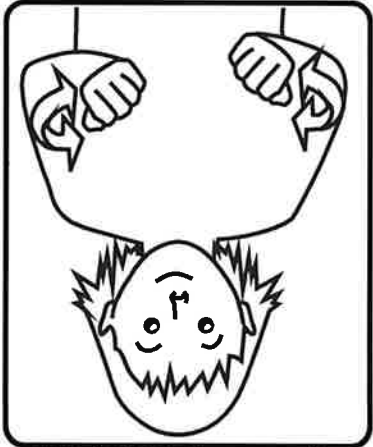
MOTORBIKE

Fingertips of R. bent 'V' hand are drawn across the back of L. wrist, then fists move in action of steering wheel.



POLICE CAR

Palm up closed hands make wide flat steering movements.



BUS, LORRY, TRUCK, VAN

VEHICLES

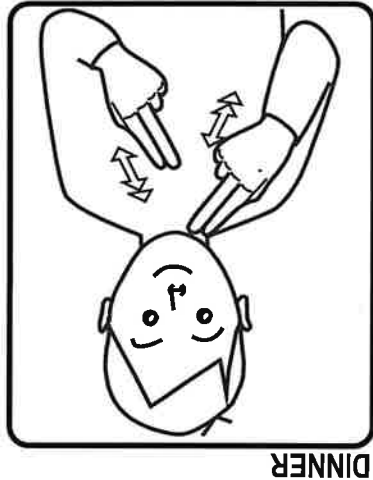
FOOD



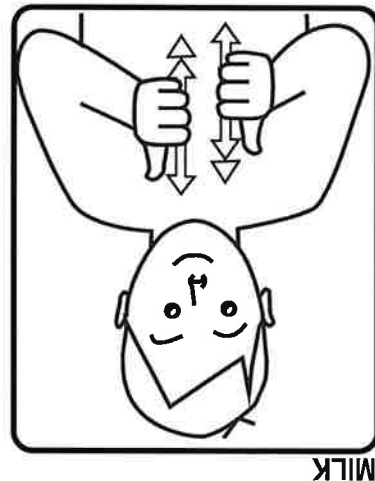
EAT, FOOD



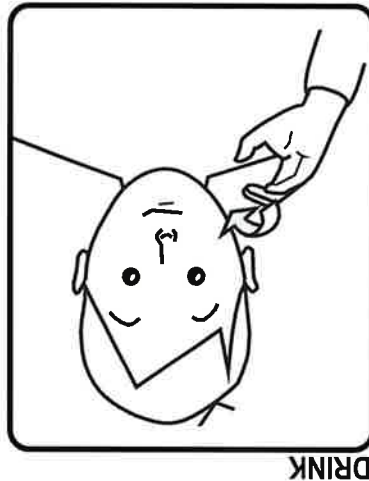
HUNGRY



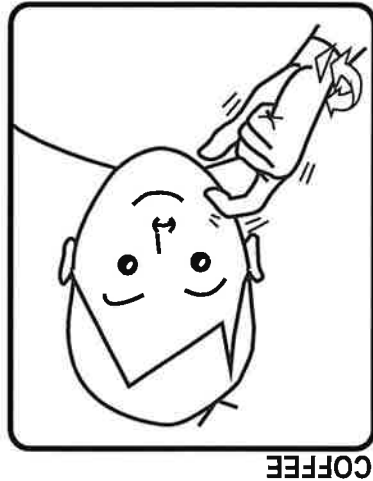
DINNER



MILK



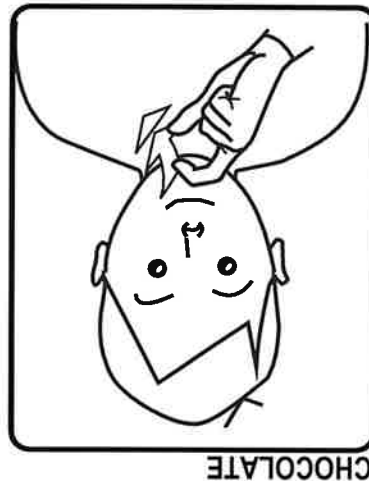
DRINK



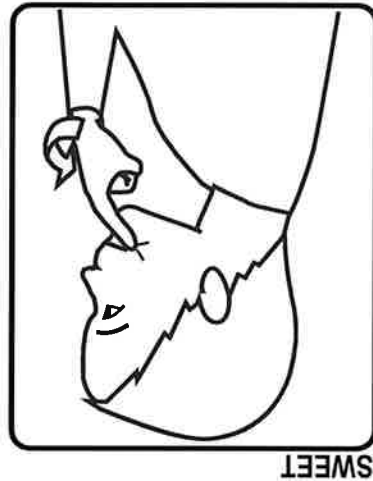
COFFEE



TEA, CAFE, CUP OF TEA

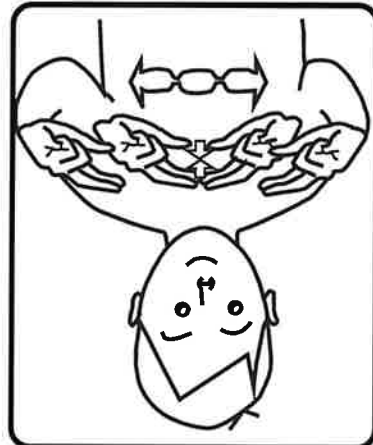


CHOCOLATE



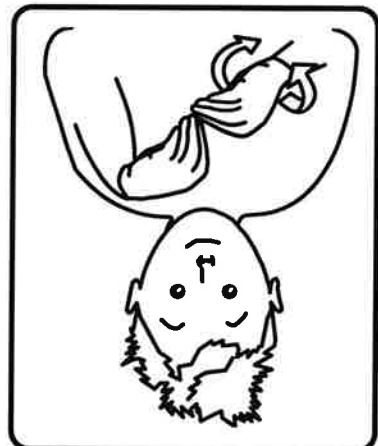
SWEET

'N' hands open and close onto thumbs several times as hands move apart.



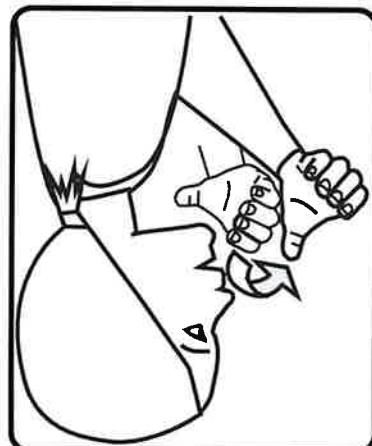
SAUSAGES

L. bunched hand held pointing downwards; tips of R. bunched hand make action of twisting grape from bunch.



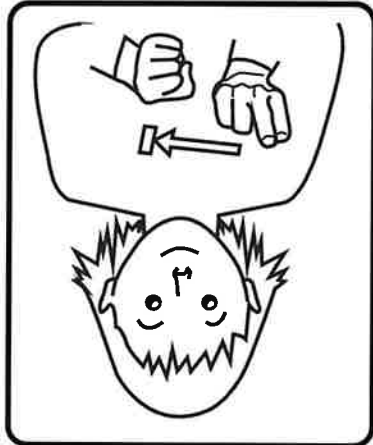
GRAPE

Full 'C' hand twists upwards and forwards from the wrist near the mouth like taking a bite.



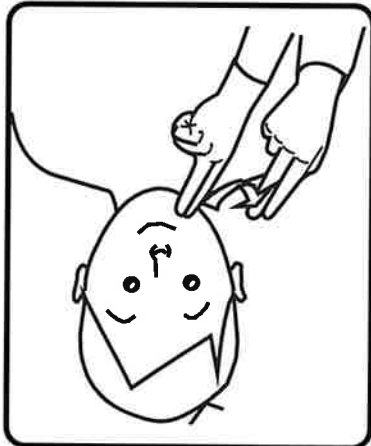
APPLE

Palm up R. 'N' hand makes slicing movement across top of L. fist.



EGG

R. 'N' hand makes soft brushing movements, twisting from palm left to palm back at side of mouth.



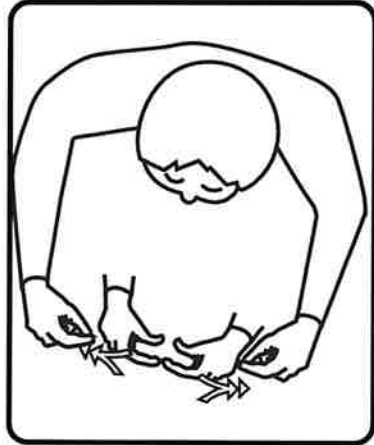
PEAR

Clawed hand makes repeated squeezing movements near side of mouth. Colours vary.



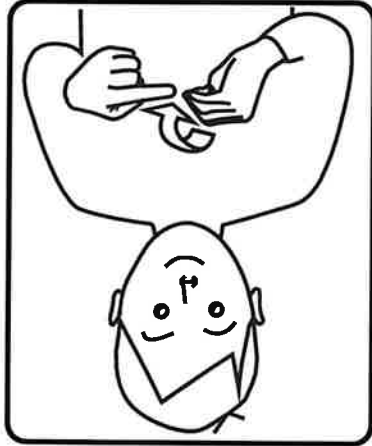
ORANGE (fruit and colour)

Index and thumbs close together repeatedly in small outward movements indicating the outline shape.



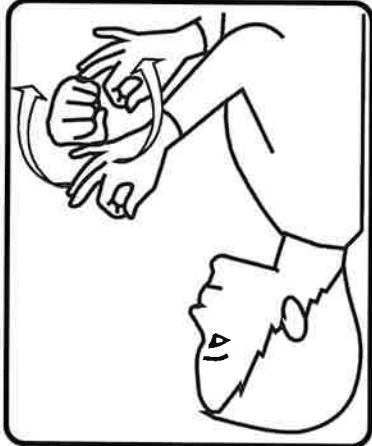
CHIPS

R. bunched hand twists against the end of L. index finger, or L. bunched hand.

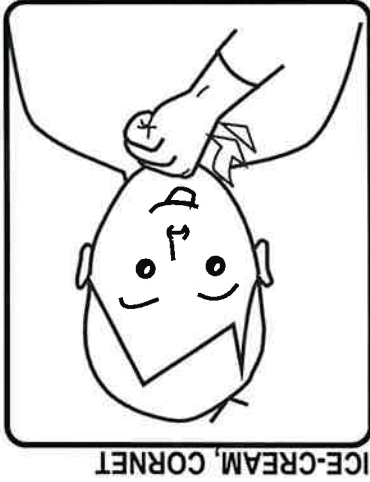


TOMATO

Mime holding and peeling a banana.

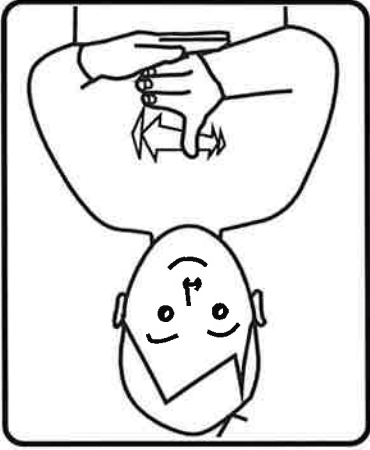


BANANA

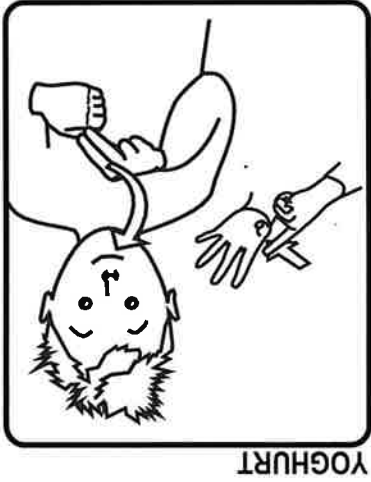


ICE-CREAM, CORNET

Fist makes repeated downward brushing movements near mouth, tongue slightly out.

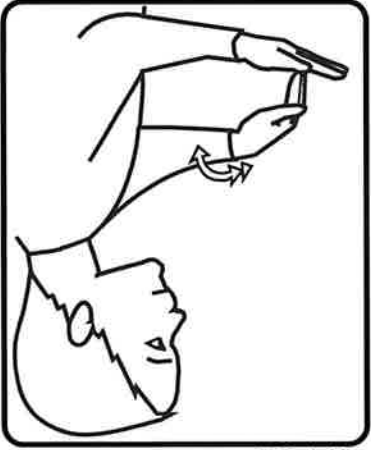


BREAD



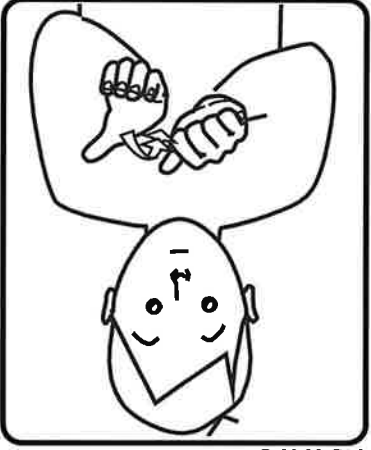
YOGHURT

Edge of R. flat hand moves in slicing action across L. palm.



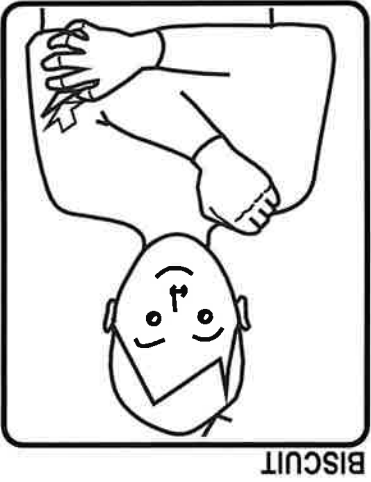
CHEESE

Fingertips of R. bent hand rest on L. palm as R. hand twists repeatedly from the wrist.



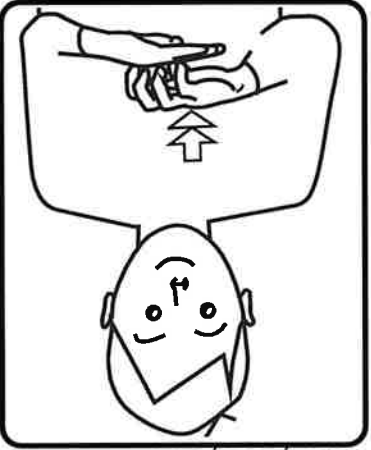
POTATO

R. thumb moves over palm of up L. full 'C' hand in action of holding and peeling a potato.



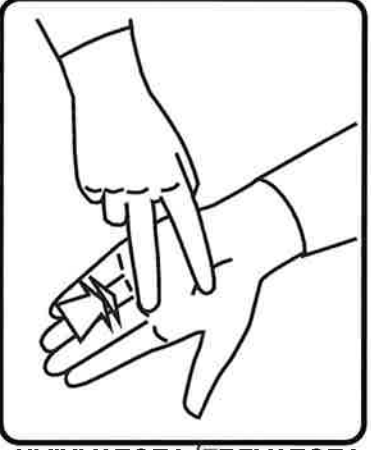
BISCUIT

Tips of R. clawed hand tap twice against left elbow.



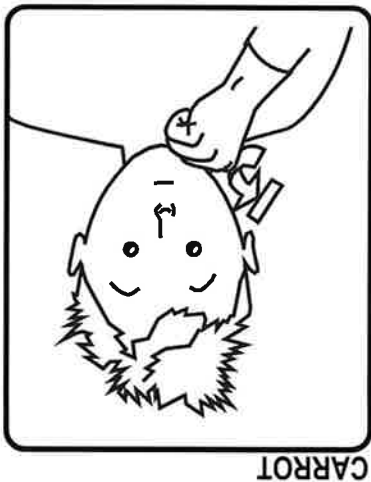
CAKE, BUN, Scone

Tips of R. clawed hand tap twice on back of L. hand. Also means ROLL, SMALL PIE.



VEGETABLE, VEGETARIAN

Hands form fingerspell 'V' with repeated movement.



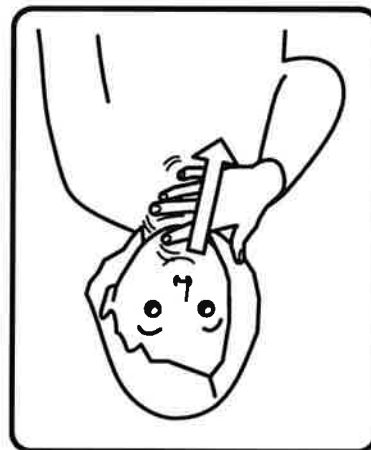
CARROT

Fist held at side of mouth makes sharp twisting movement as if holding and taking a bite from a carrot.



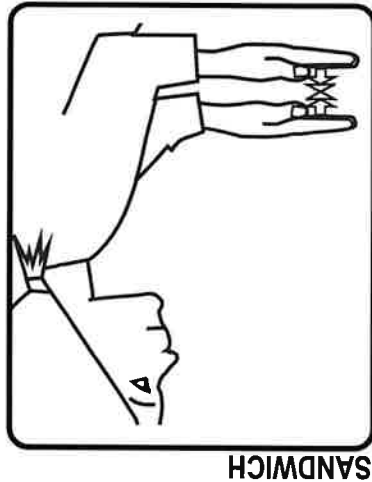
CRISPS

R. 'O' hand moves repeatedly up to mouth from L. palm. Bunched hand may be used.



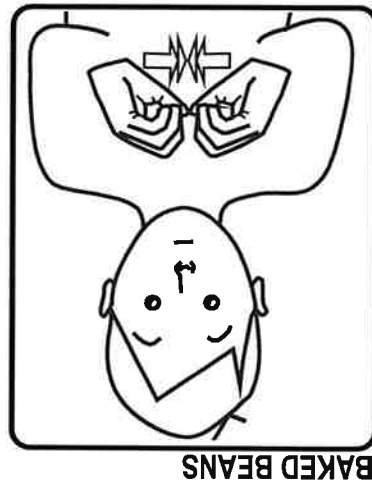
JUICE

Fingers of palm back open hand wiggle as hand moves downwards from the chin.



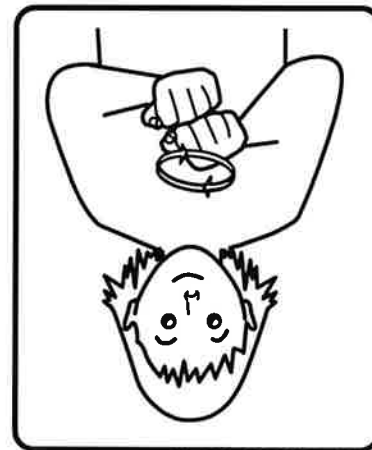
SANDWICH

Flat hands pat together twice, palm to palm.



BAKED BEANS

Hands form repeated fingerspell 'BB'.



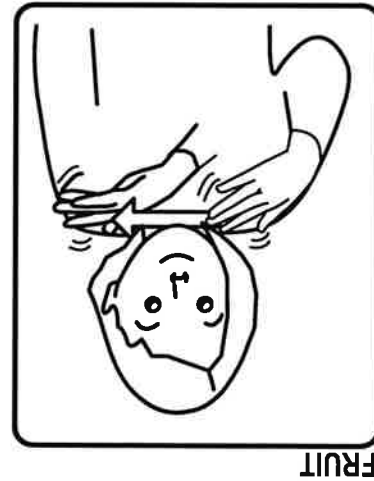
CHEW, CHEW UP

R. closed hand rests on top of L. and moves in anticlockwise circles. The mouth makes chewing movements.



HOT

Clawed hand is drawn sharply across the mouth. Can be flat hand drawn across forehead then shaken.



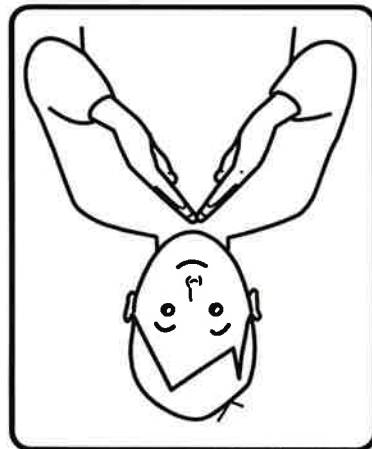
FRUIT

Fingers waggle as R. hand moves from right to left under the chin.

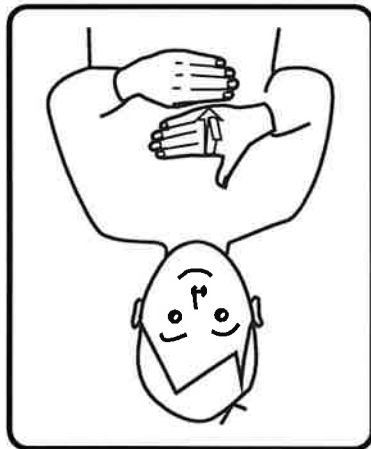


PIZZA

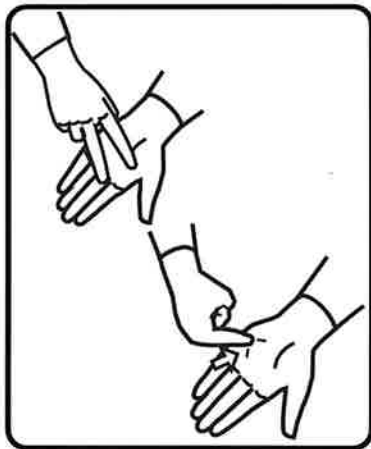
Fingerspell 'P' 'Z' followed by R. index pointing down above L. palm moves round in circle.



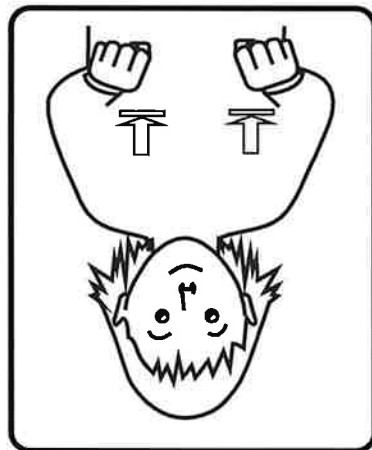
Flat hands held at an angle, touch at fingertips.



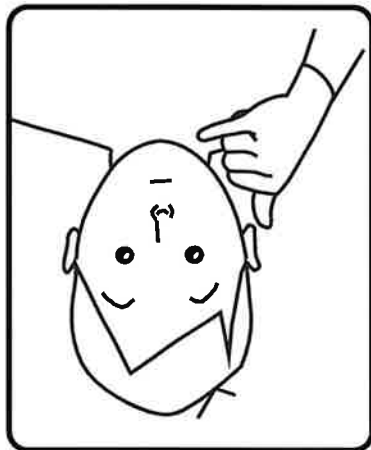
R. palm back flat hand moves up and down on top of L.



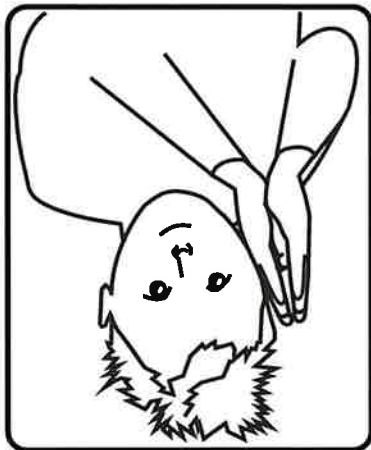
Fingerspell 'TV'.



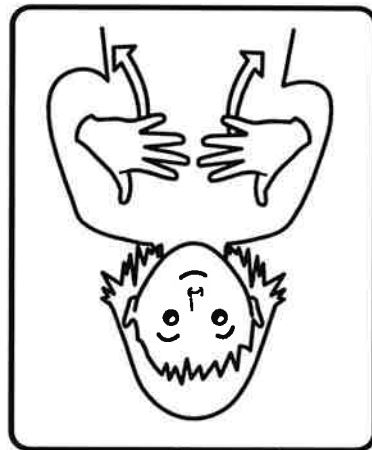
Palm down fists make short firm movement down.



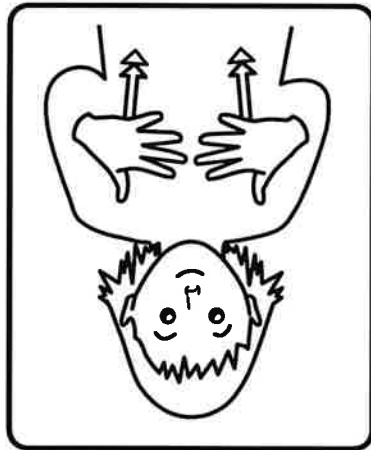
'Y' hand held near ear.



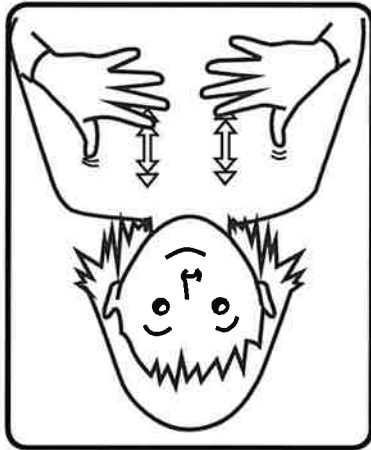
Head tilts onto both hands held together. Eyes are closed for SLEEP.



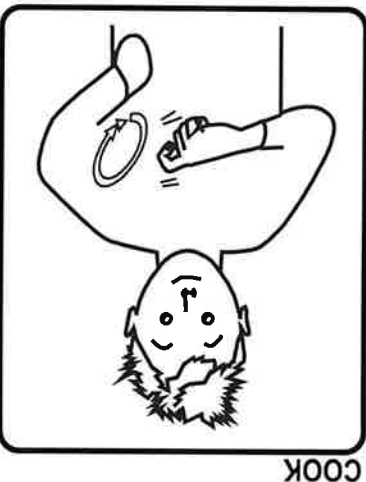
Open hands brush down chest and apart finishing palm down.



Open hands brush downwards twice on body.

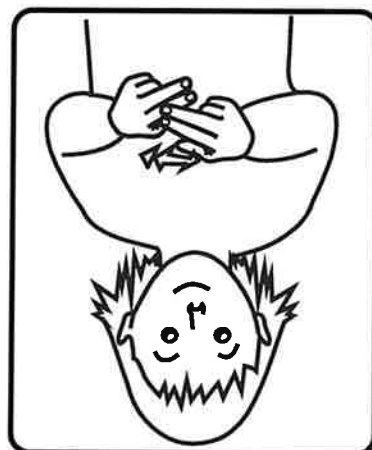


Open hands move up and down chest several times. Closed hands can be used.



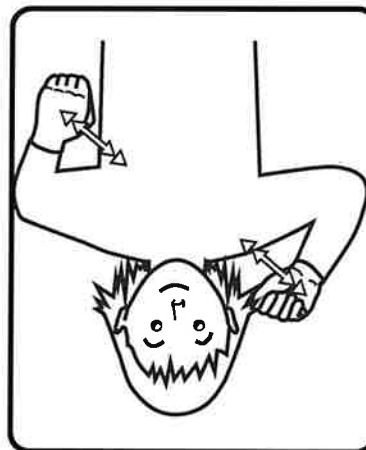
COOK

Irish 'T' hand makes whisking movements in crook of left arm.



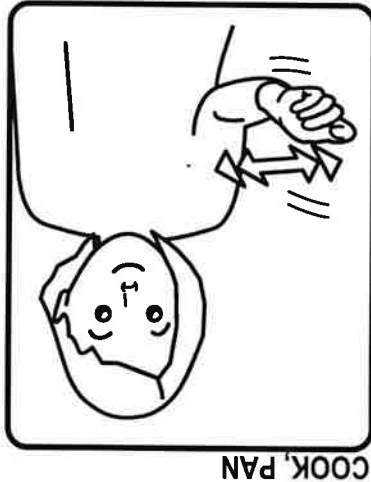
KNIFE, CUTLERY

Middle finger edge of R. 'N' hand makes small sawing movements on L. 'N' hand. Also means RESTAURANT.



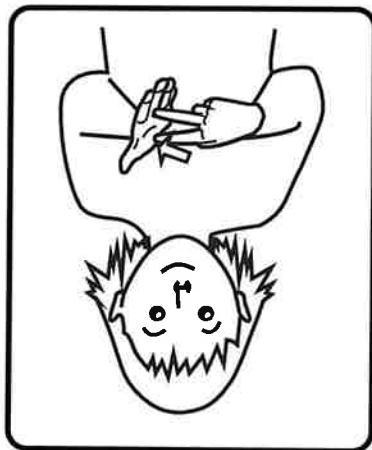
TOWEL

Closed hands move in action of holding and drying with a bath towel.



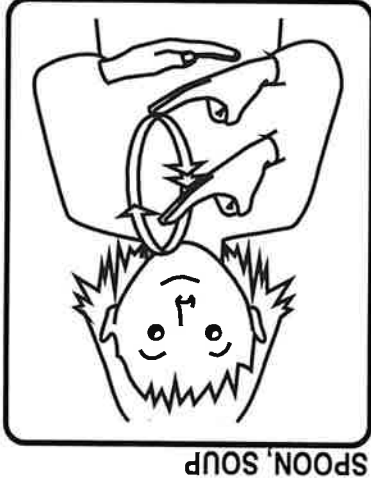
COOK, PAN

Hand in Irish 'T' hands shape makes repeated shaking movements forward/back.



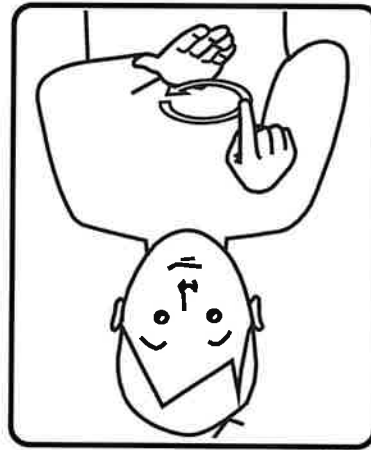
FORK

Tips of index and middle finger prod into L. palm.



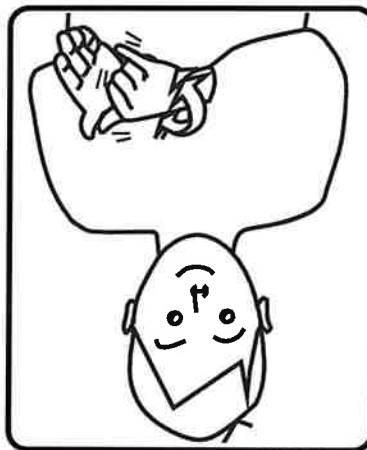
SPOON, SOUP

Palm up 'N' hand makes repeated upward circular movements to the mouth from L. palm.



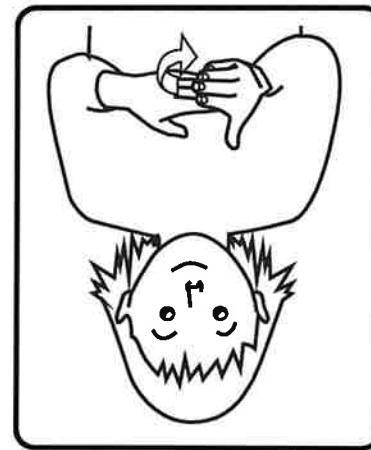
PLATE

R. index finger pointing down makes small circles around L. palm.



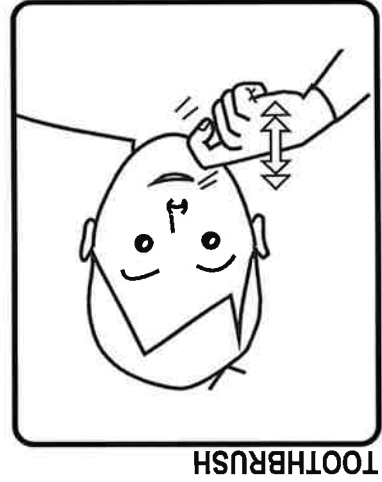
CD-ROM

Knuckles of R. 'Y' hand contact L. palm as R. hand twists repeatedly from the wrist.



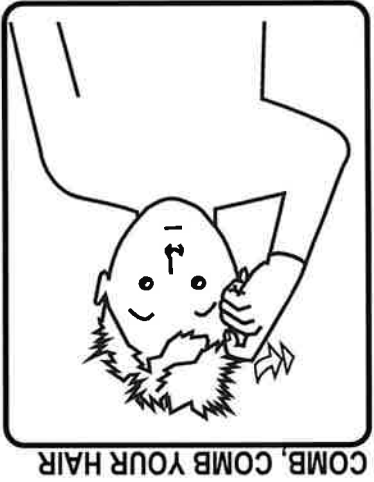
DOOR, GATE

R. hand pivots forwards and back from wrist in front of L.



TOOTHBRUSH

Irish 'T' hand (or index finger) makes brushing movements near the mouth. Also means CLEAN (DO) ONE'S TEETH.



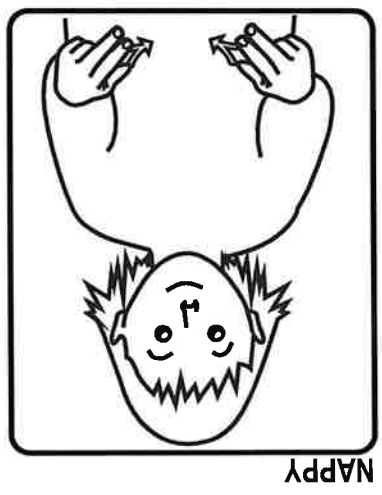
COMB, COMB YOUR HAIR

Irish 'T' hand moves in action of using a hair comb.



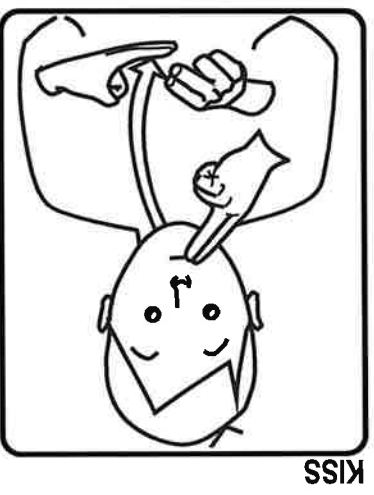
BRUSH (hair)

Closed hand moves in action of brushing hair near side of head.



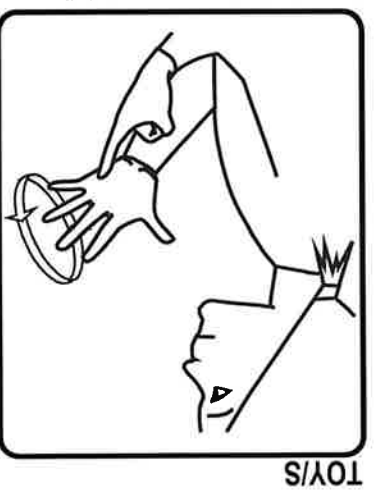
NAPPY

Fingers of 'N' hands snap shut onto thumbs at sides of lower body.



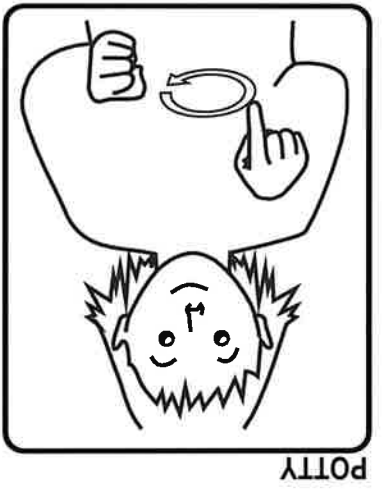
KISS

Tips of R. 'N' hand contact lips, then move down to contact tips of L. 'N' hand.



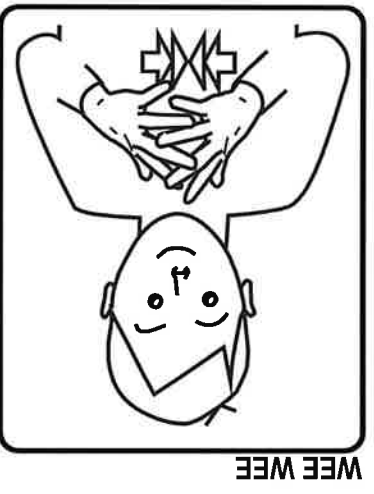
TOY/S

Hands in fingerspell 'T' formation move in small circular movements.



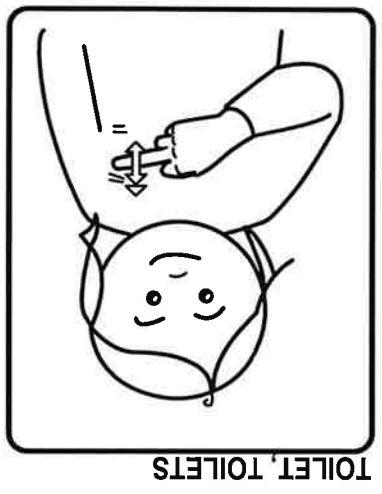
POTTY

R. index finger pointing down moves in circle above and to the right of L. fist.



WEE WEE

Fingers form fingerspell 'W' with two movements.



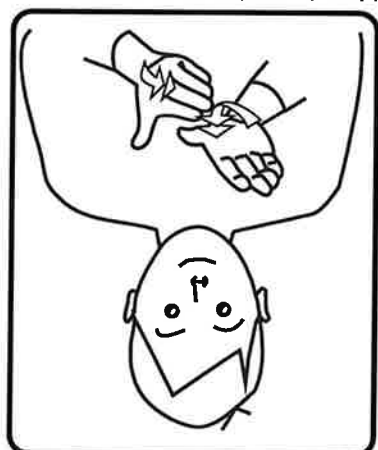
TOILET, TOILETS

Tip of middle finger rubs up and down on left side of chest.



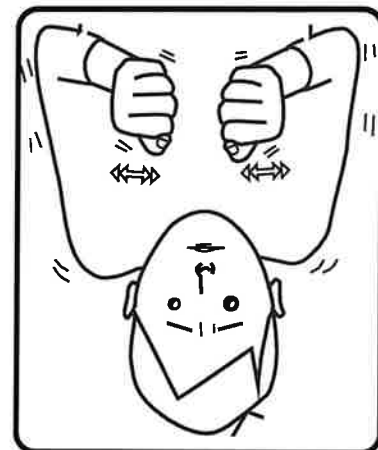
LAUGH, FUN, FUNNY

'C' hand makes small shaking movements under the chin.



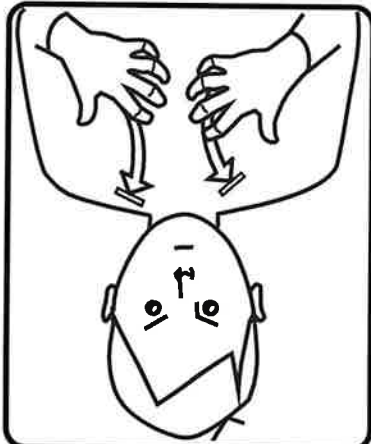
HAPPY, ENJOY, GLAD

Hands make repeated contact brushing against each other, with pleased expression.



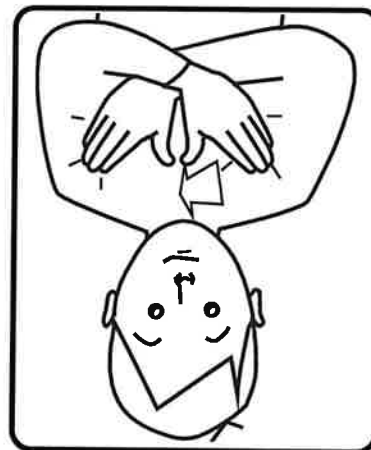
COLD

Closed hands and elbows pull into body in shivering action, shoulders hunched, cheeks puffed.



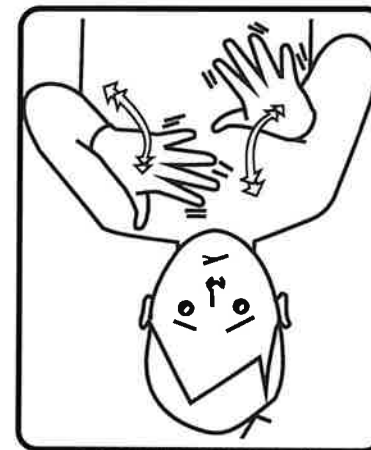
CROSS, ANGRY

Clawed hands move up body sharply twisting to palm up, cheeks puffed, brows furrowed.



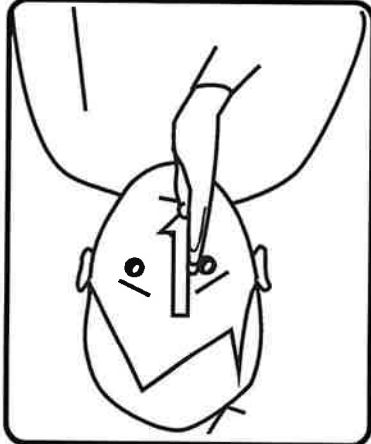
LOVE, DEAR

Flat hands (or closed hands) are held crossed on the chest.



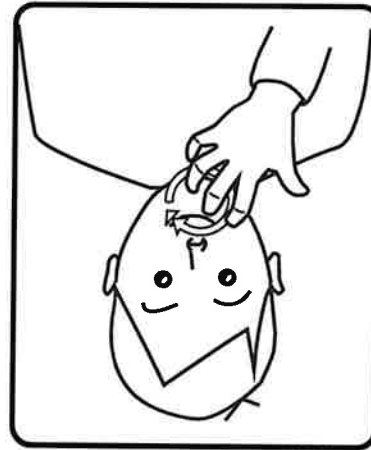
HURT, PAIN/FUL, SORE

Palm back open hands shake alternately up and down from the wrists with pained expression.



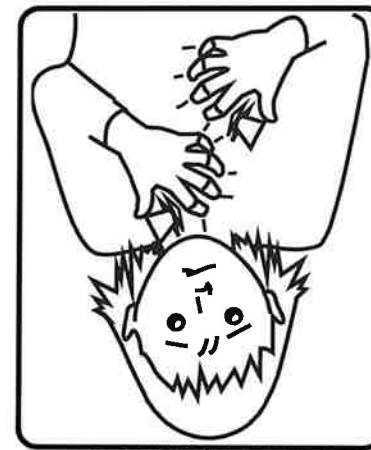
SAD

Palm left R. flat hand moves down in front of nose. Mouth and shoulders droop.



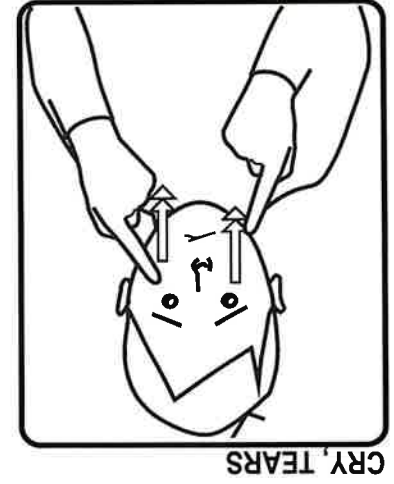
WARM

Clawed hand makes small circling movements in front of mouth.



FRIGHTENED, SCARED

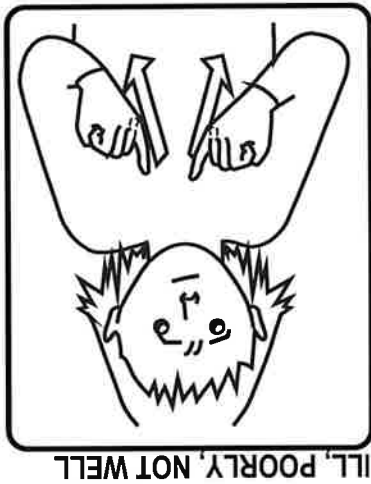
Tips of clawed hands tap chest twice as body cringes backwards.



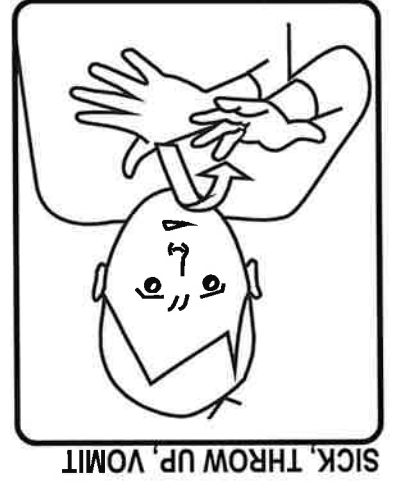
Index fingers move down cheeks under eyes alternately. One hand may be used.



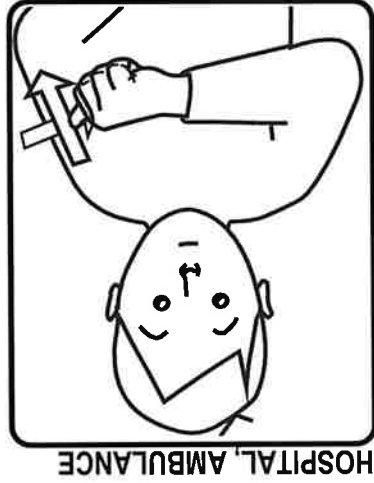
Closed hand rubs in circular movements on the chest with sorrowful expression.



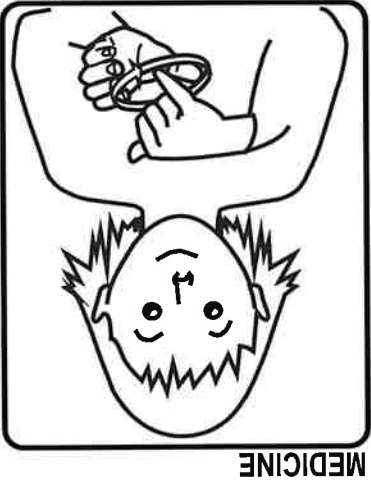
Little fingers (or just one hand) brush down the chest. The head may tilt and movement repeat. Also means **TIRE**D.



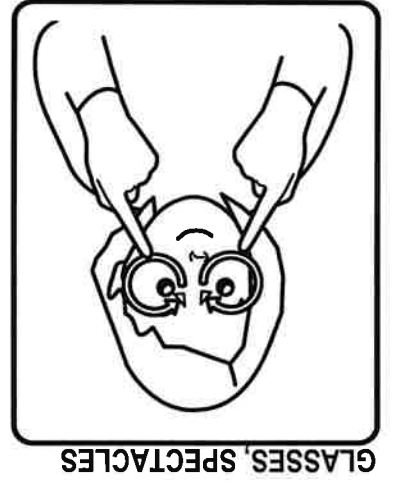
Open hand brushes upwards on chest, and up past the mouth tipping forward to palm up.



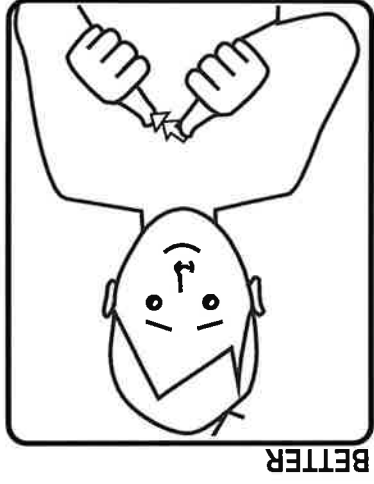
R. thumb tip draws cross on left upper arm. Also one version of **NURSE**.



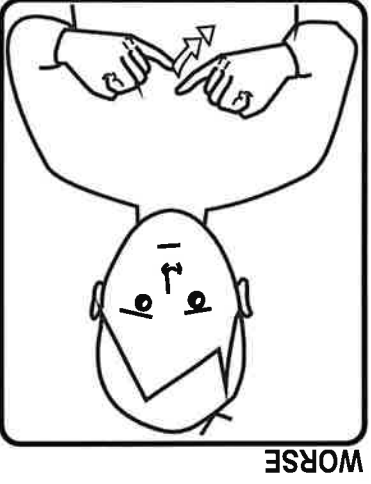
Extended R. little finger makes circular movements inside L. cupped hand.



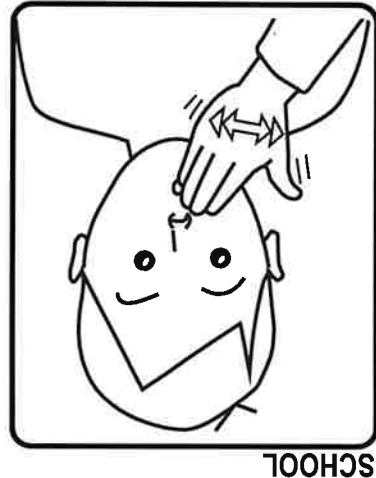
Index fingers circle the eyes in outline of glasses.



Tip of R. extended thumb makes two small forward brushing movements against top of L. thumb.



R. little finger brushes downwards twice off L. little finger. Brows are furrowed.



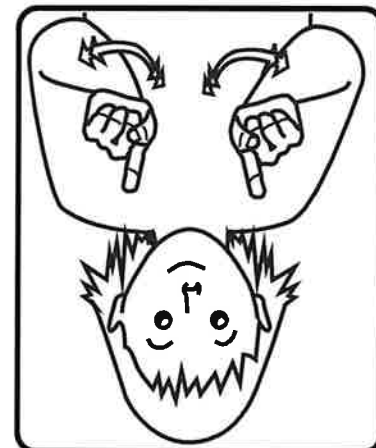
SCHOOL

Palm back flat hand makes side to side or circular movements in front of mouth.



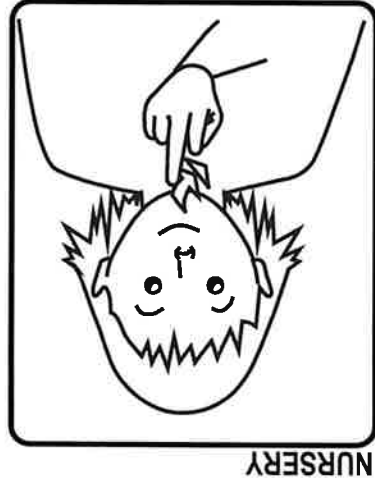
ASSEMBLY

Open hands held apart and facing, twist over and down towards each other. Fingers indicate a gathering of people.



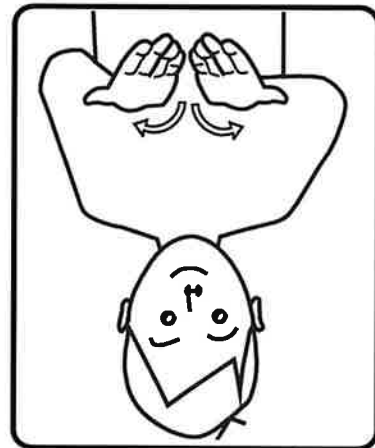
MUSIC

Extended index fingers swing in and out towards each other several times.



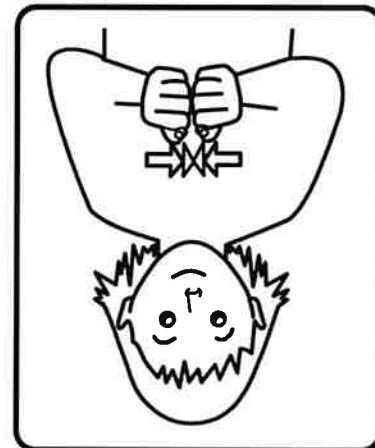
NURSERY

Tip of extended middle finger brushes down chin twice.



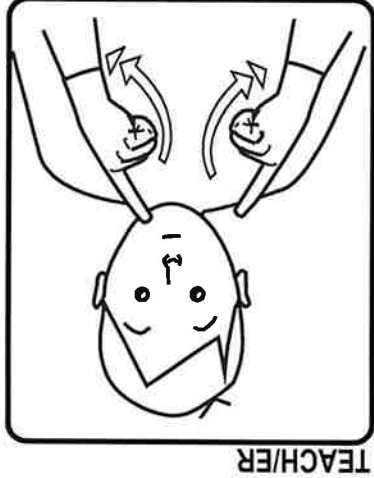
BOOK, READ

Flat hands start palm to palm, then twist open and apart. Wiggle slightly from side to side for READ.



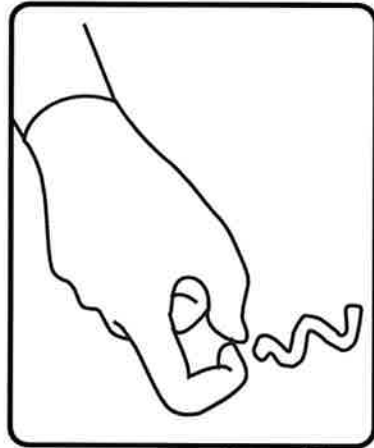
PAPER

Tap knuckles of both closed hands together twice.



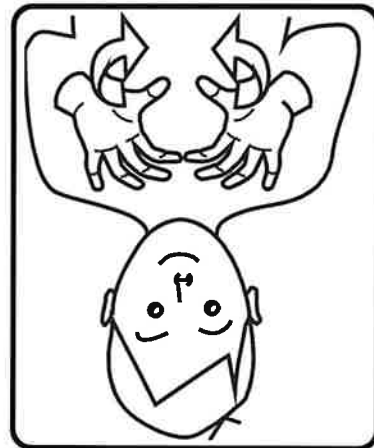
TEACHER

Index fingers near the mouth move forward, down and apart in two short movements.



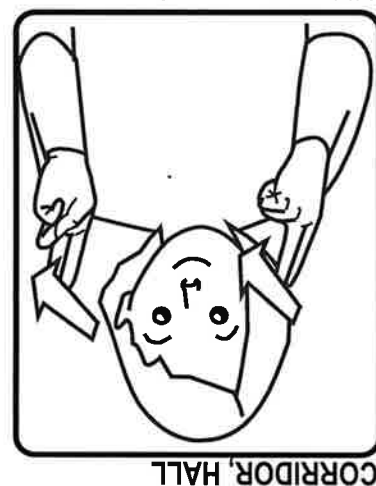
PEN, PENCIL

Bent index and thumb tip in contact; hand moves to the right in small squiggles, or across L. palm.

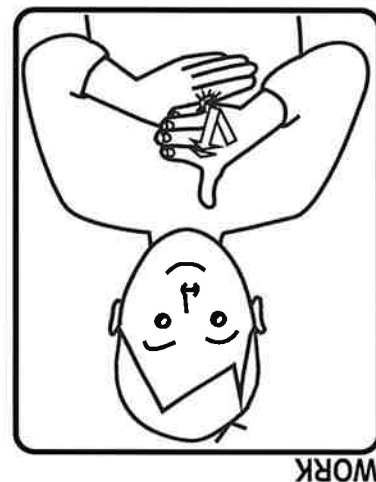


BALL, FOOTBALL

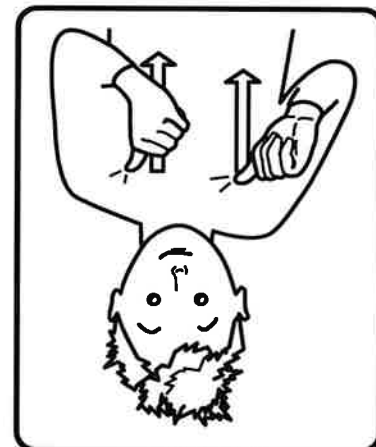
Hands with fingers curved move round and apart in shape of large ball.



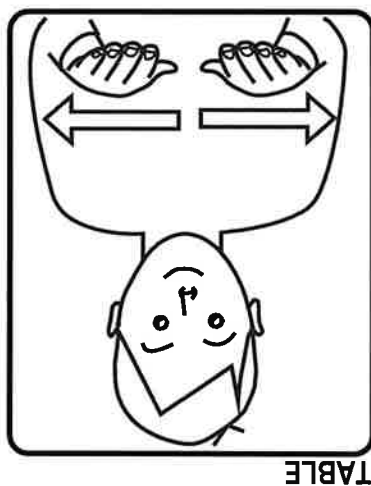
'N' hands move forward at sides of head. Flat hands can be used.



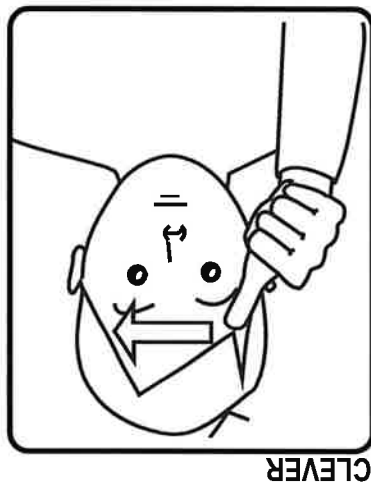
Edge of R. flat hands makes short forward tapping movements on L. at right angles.



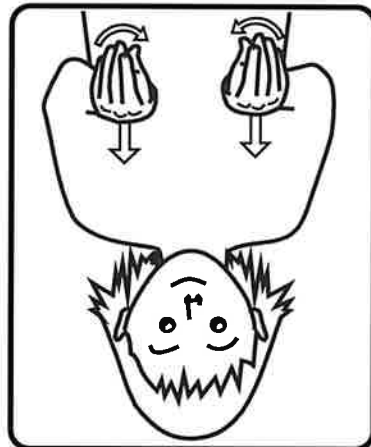
Tips of extended thumbs move simultaneously down the chest.



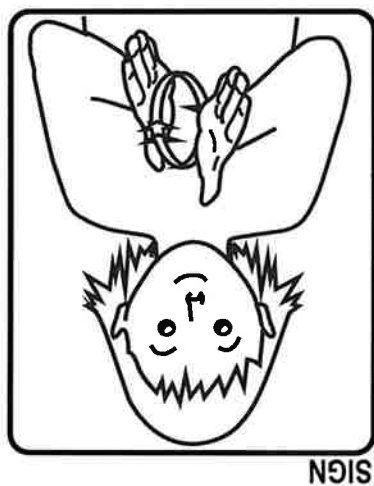
Palm down flat hands move apart.



Tip of extended thumb moves sharply right to left across the forehead.



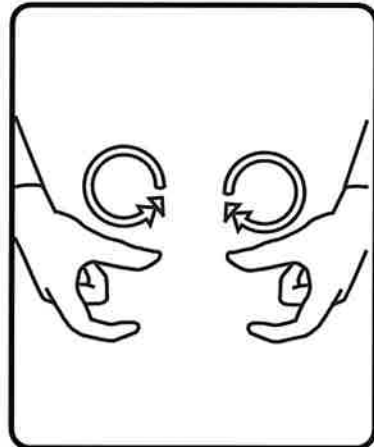
Thumbs rub across pads of fingers in crumbling action as hands move upwards. Also means FLOUR.



Hands circle forward round each other several times.



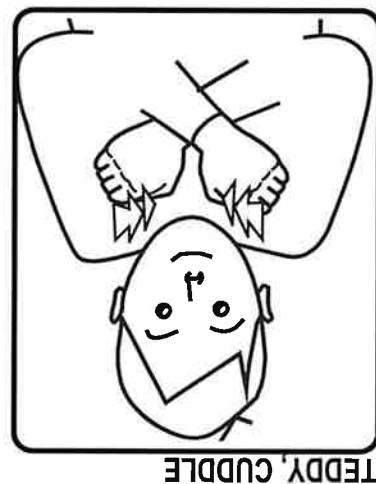
Tip of R. thumb prods into L. palm twice.



'C' hands move in small simultaneous circular movements.

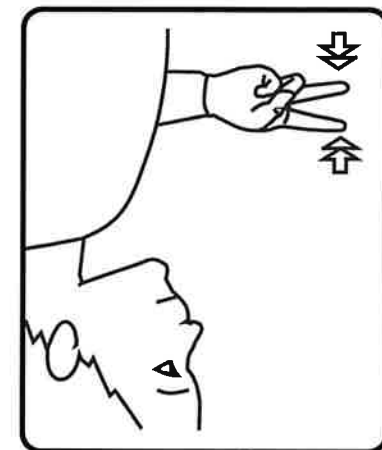


WATER



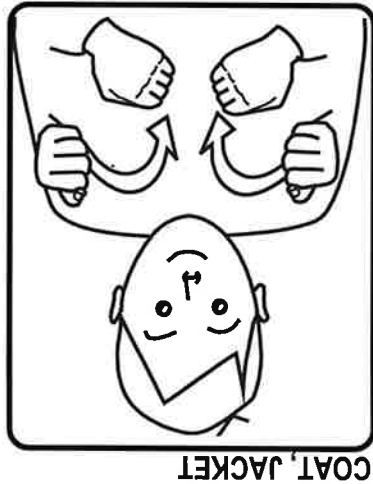
TEDDY, CUDDLE

Closed hands are crossed and tap twice, hugging into chest.



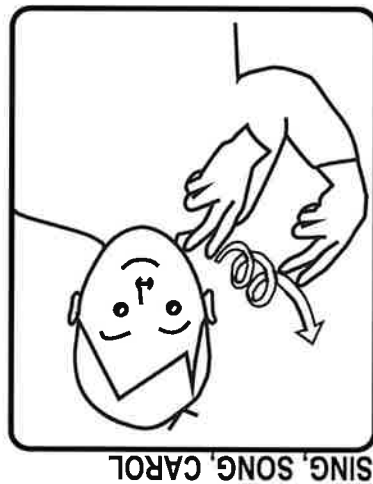
SCISSORS, CUT

Fingers of 'V' hand open and close twice.



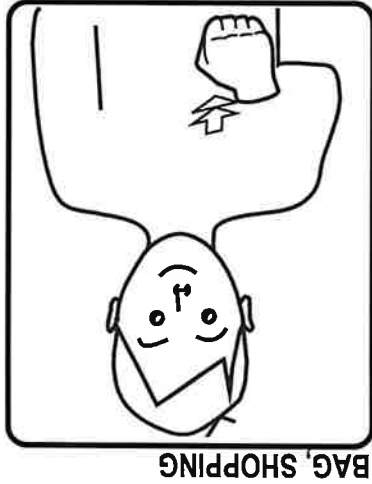
COAT, JACKET

Closed hands move down and round from shoulders in action of putting coat on.



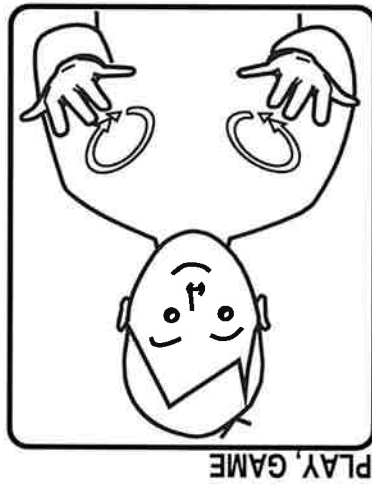
SING, SONG, CAROL

Palm back 'V' hand makes spiralling upward movements from near mouth.



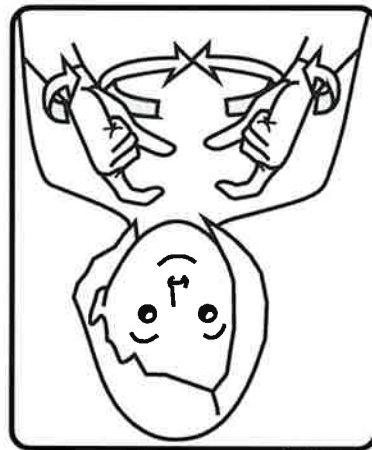
BAG, SHOPPING

Palm back closed hand makes short repeated downward movements.



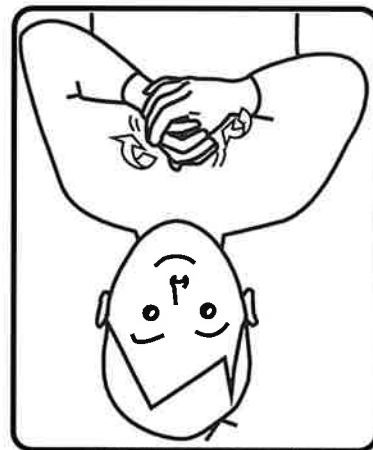
PLAY, GAME

Palm up open hands move in simultaneous circular movements.



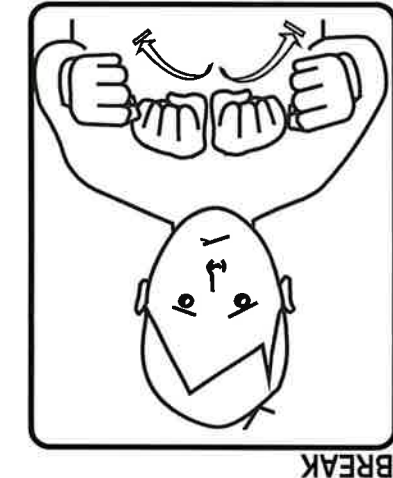
CLASS, CLASSROOM

'C' hands face each other then twist apart and round to finish touching with palms facing back.



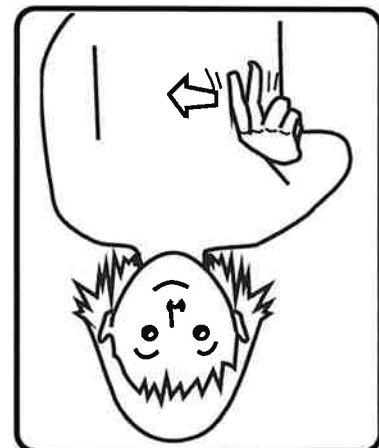
WASH, WASH HANDS

Hands rub together, or rub on appropriate part of body. Also means **SOAP**.



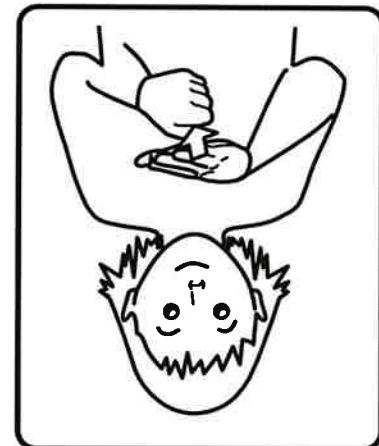
BREAK

Fists held together twist apart in snapping action.



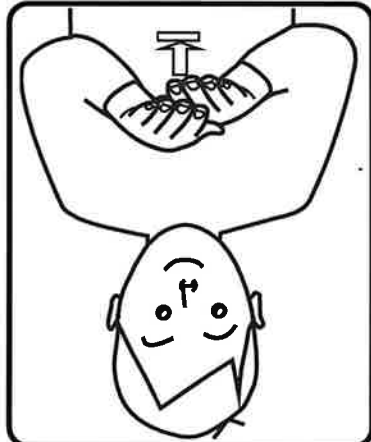
WALK

Fingers of 'V' hand wiggle as hand moves forward or in *direction* to suit context.



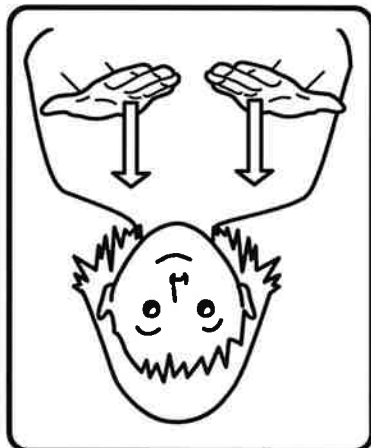
MORE

R. flat hand taps down on top of L. fist.



SIT DOWN

Palm down flat hands, one on top of the other, make short firm movement down.



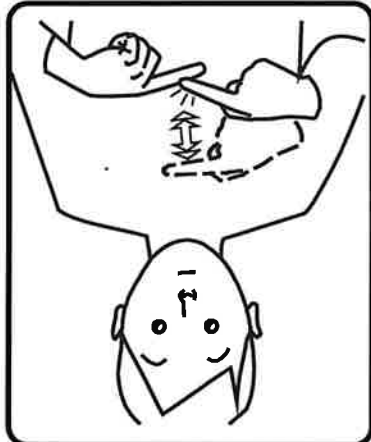
GET UP, STAND UP

Palm up flat hands move upwards.



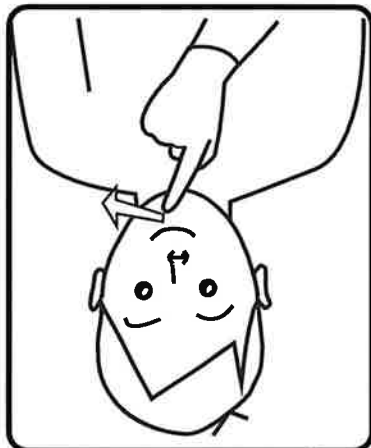
STOP, WAIT, HOLD ON

Palm forward flat hand makes a short firm forward movement. Repeats for **WAIT**, **HOLD ON** etc.



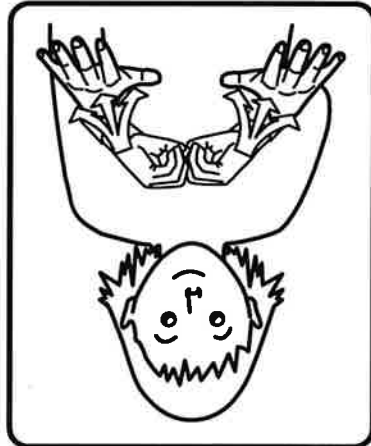
HURRY, BE QUICK

R. index finger taps quickly up and down on L. index finger several times.



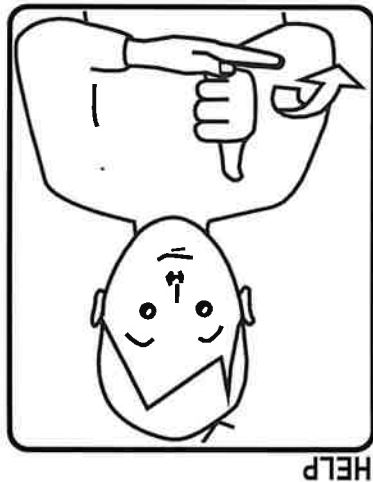
SAY, TELL

Index moves forward from the mouth. Used for **TALK** and similar meanings.



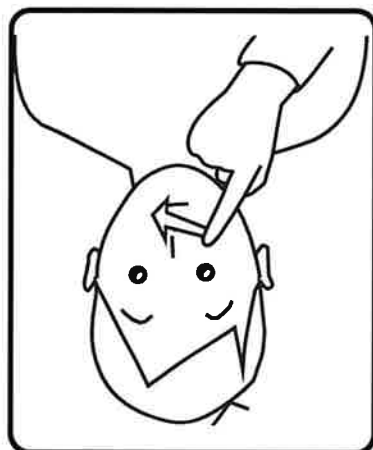
FINISH

'O' hands contact each other, then hands spring open, then hands spring open, then hands spring open.



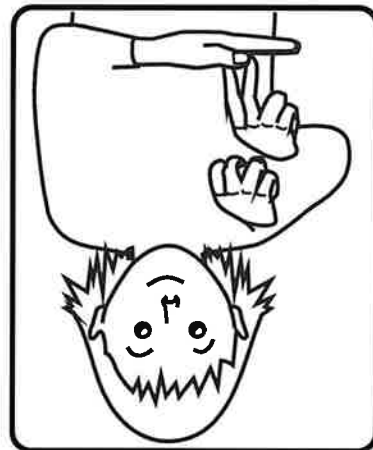
HELP

Closed hand with thumb up rests on L. palm as hands move forward together.



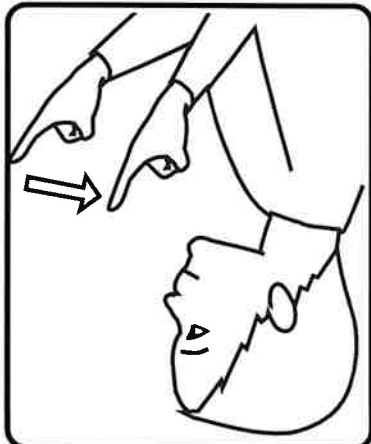
SEE, LOOK

Index finger moves forward from eye. Can also be signed with 'V' hand.



JUMP

R. 'V' hand jumps up flexing on L. palm or in way to suit context. Repeated for **BABY BOUNCER, TRAMPOLINE.**



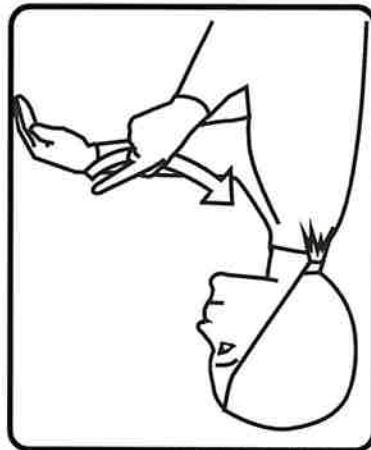
COME, COME BACK

Index finger held forward moves back to body. Index finger may be bent or flex (COME HERE).



LISTEN, HEAR

Cupped hand held behind ear.



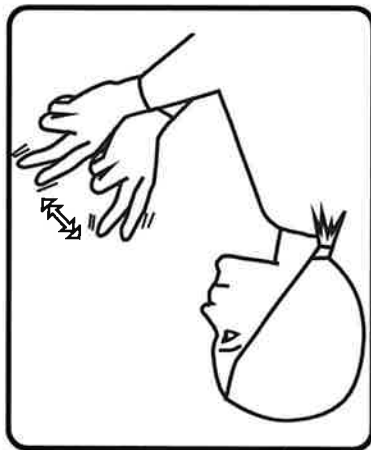
SLOW, SLOWLY

R. index finger brushes from left wrist up the forearm. Also means **LONG TIME.**



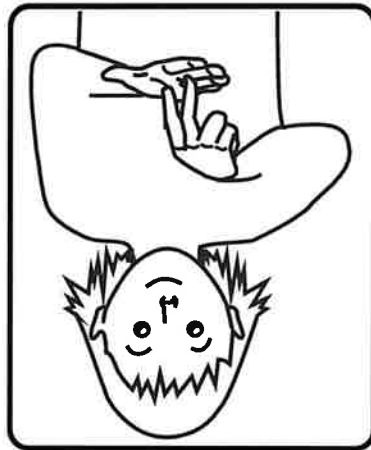
GO, GONE, WENT, SENT

Index finger swings forward/up from wrist to point forward.



AGAIN, REPEAT

Palm left 'V' hand makes short quick shaking movements forward/down from the wrist.



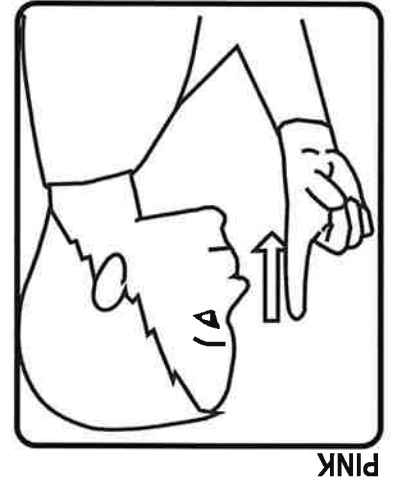
STAND

R. 'V' hand stands on L. palm.

COLOURS/DESCRIPTORS



Palm forward open hand makes anticlockwise circular movements.



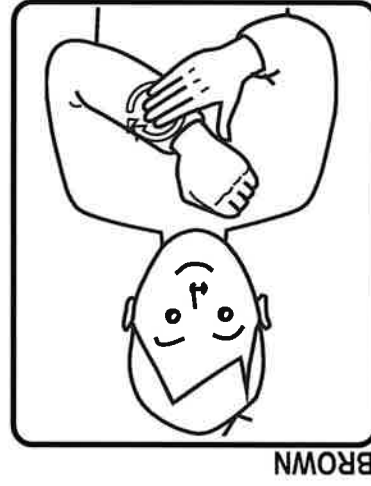
Palm left R. index moves down in front of nose.



Tips of 'O' hand make small repeated brushing movements near the collar.



R. index finger rubs to and fro on L. wrist, or on back of L. hand.



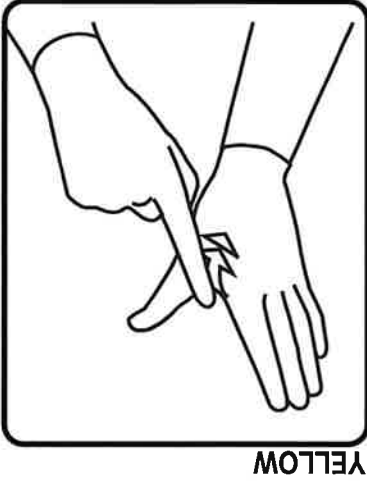
R. hand rubs in small circles on left forearm.



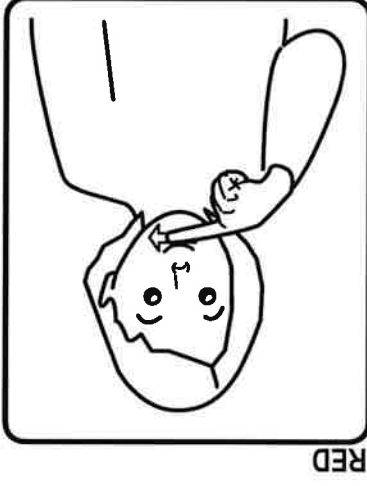
Form fingerspell 'P' and make small forward brushing movements off L. index with R. 'O' hand.



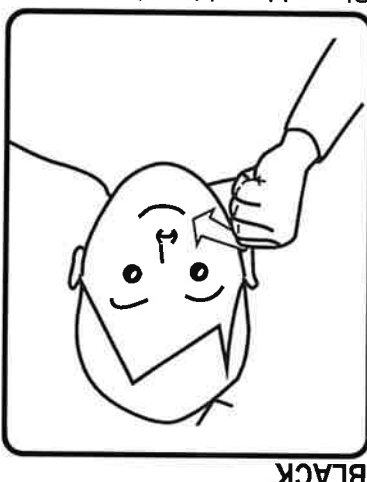
R. flat hand sweeps up left forearm.



Fingerspell 'Y' and make small repeated brushing movements with R. index.

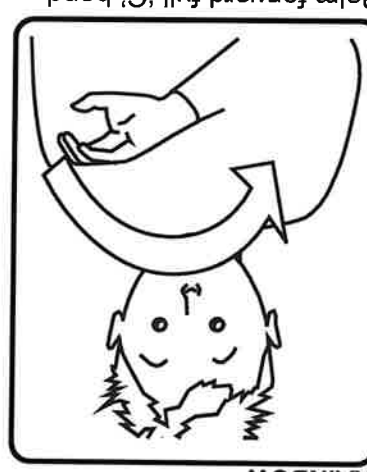


R. index finger brushes to the left across the bottom lip.



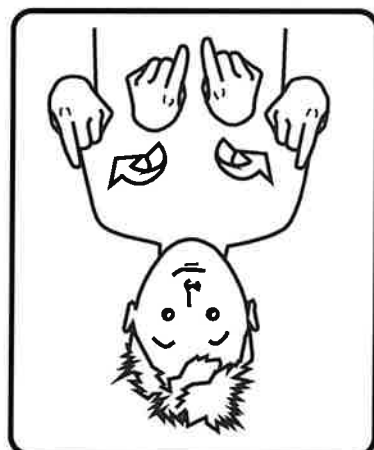
BLACK

Closed hand brushes forward/down on side of cheek.



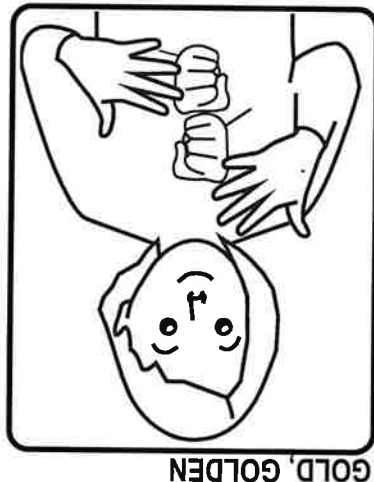
RAINBOW

Palm forward full 'C' hand moves over in large arc.



DIFFERENT

Index fingers held together twist over and apart.



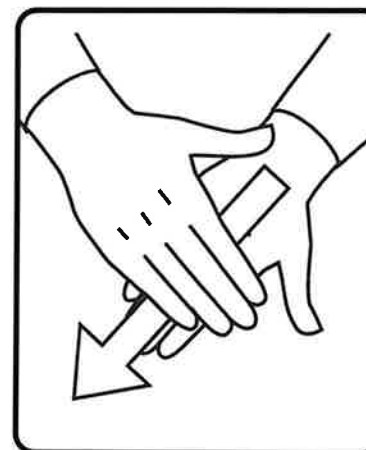
GOLD, GOLDEN

Hands form fingerspelt 'G' then spring open and apart.



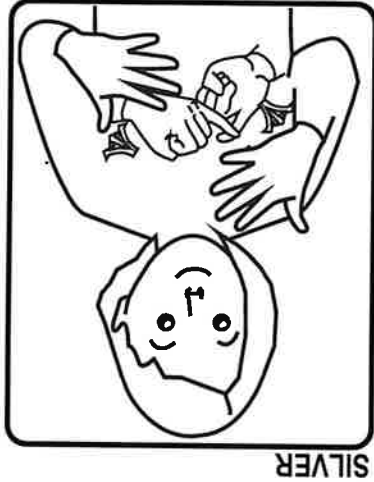
ORANGE (fruit and colour)

Clawed hand makes repeated squeezing movements near side of mouth.



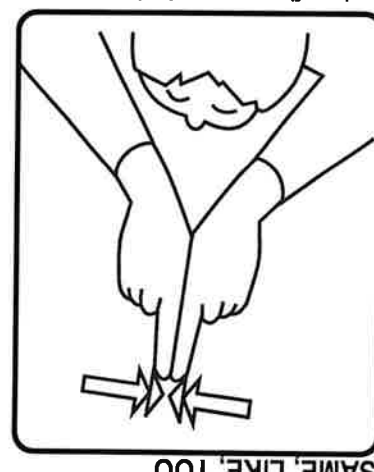
CLEAN

R. hand brushes forward/right along L. palm.



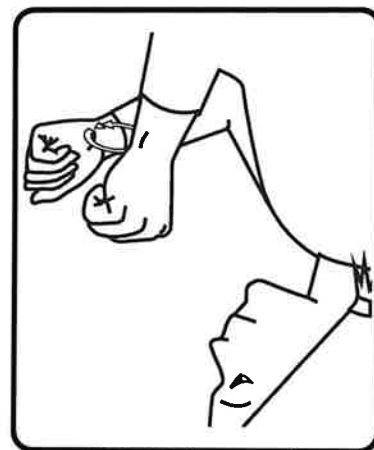
SILVER

Hands form fingerspelt 'S', then hands spring open and apart.



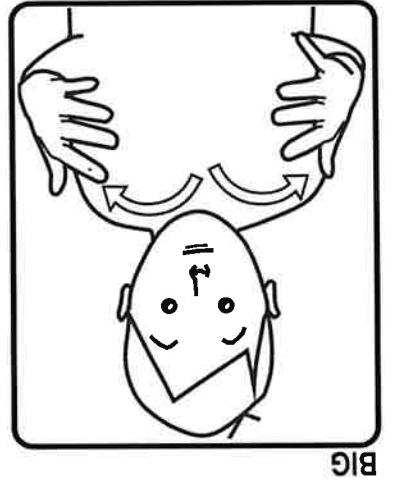
SAME, LIKE, TOO

Index fingers pointing forward contact each other. May tap twice or make single contact.

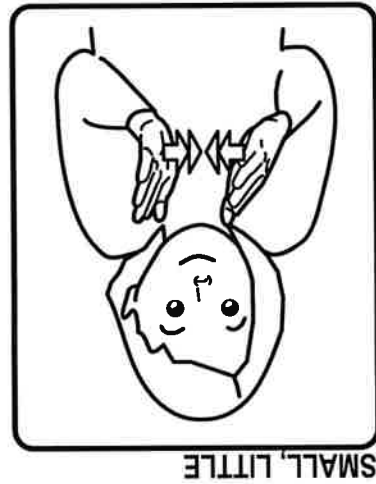


DIRTY, GRIMY, MUCKY

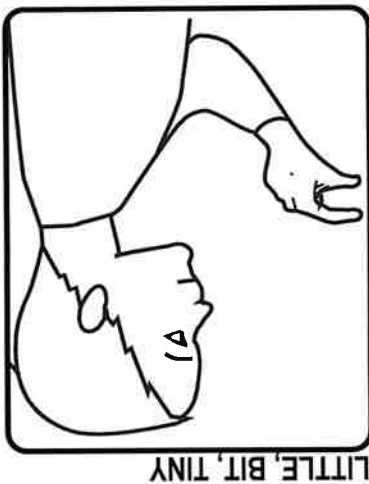
Closed hands rub together at the wrists with appropriate facial expression.



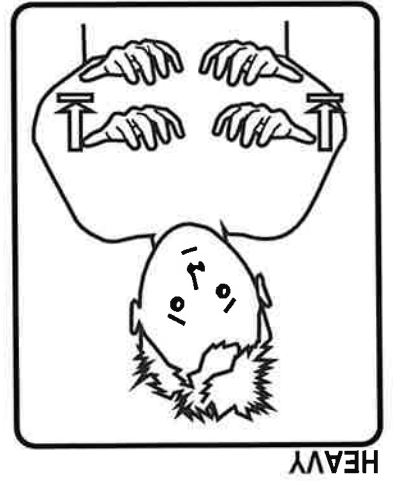
Open hands move apart in small arcs with emphasis.



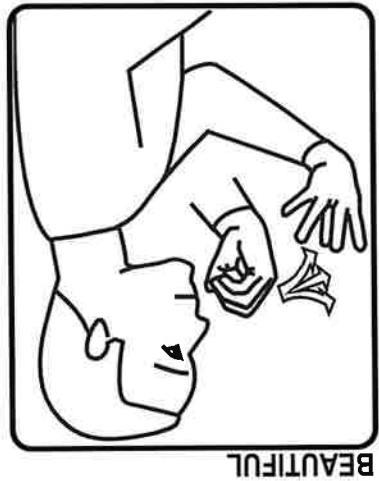
Palm facing hands make two short movements towards each other, shoulders slightly hunched.



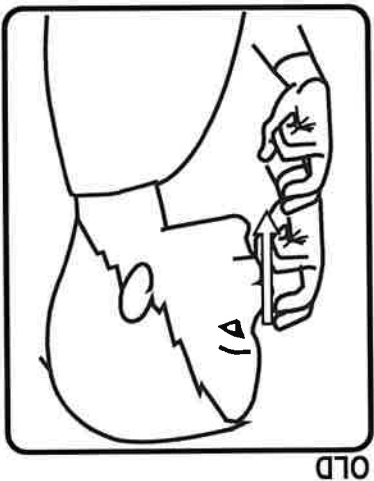
Index and thumb indicate small amount.



Palm up hands move down with stress (may repeat) shoulders sag.



Tips of bunched hand spring forward and open from the lips.



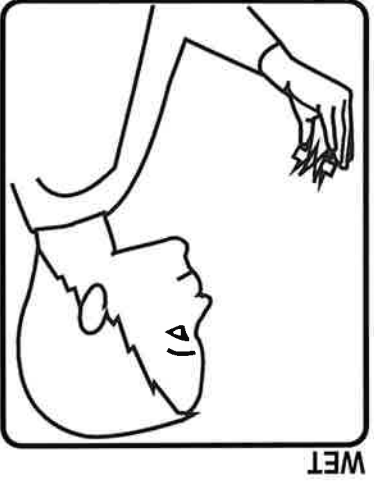
Fingers of 'V' hand flex as hand moves down in front of nose.



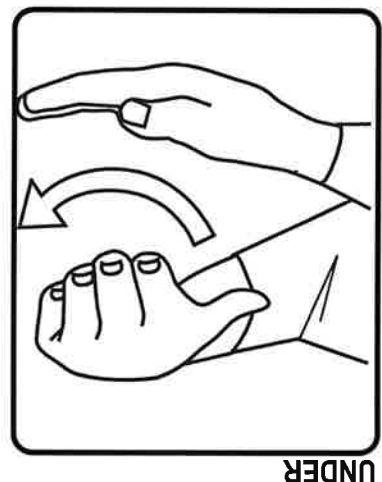
R. flat hand brushes sharply up behind L.



Thumbs rub across the fingertips from little fingers to indexes. One hand can be used.



Fingers of bent hand open and close onto thumb several times. Two hands can be used.



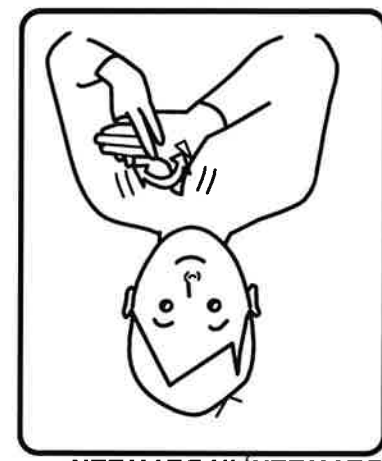
UNDER

Palm up R. hand moves forward under palm down L. hand in small arc.



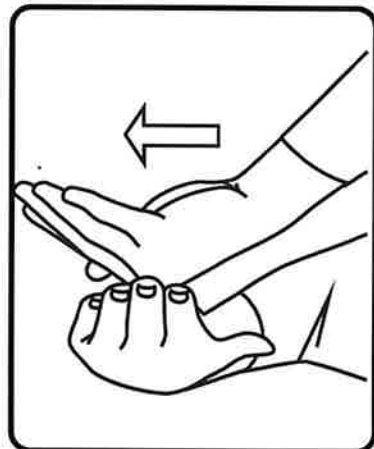
OVER

R. bent hand moves over L. hand in small arc.



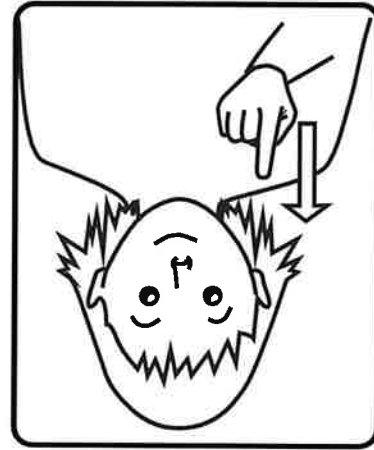
BETWEEN, IN BETWEEN

R. flat hand slots between the middle and ring fingers of L. hand and waggles from side to side.



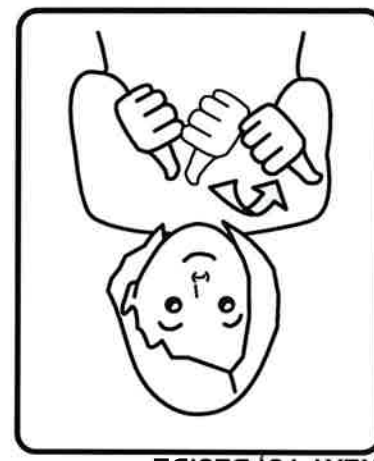
IN

R. bent hand straightens to a flat hand as it moves forward under L. hand.



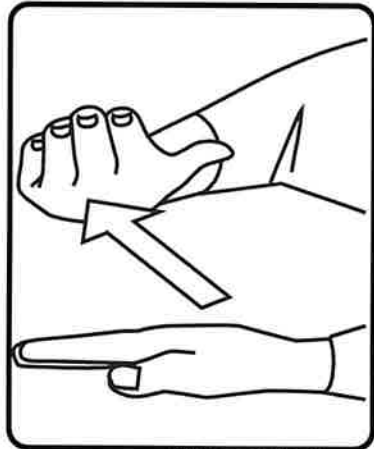
UP

Index finger points up and makes small upward movement. Repeated movement for UPSTAIRS.



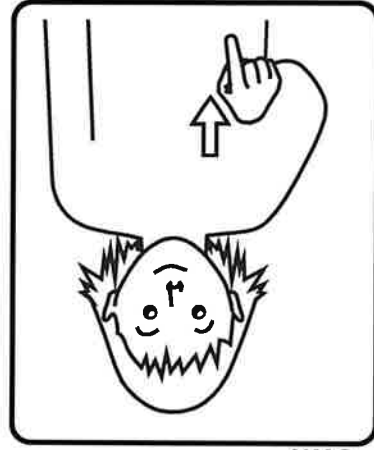
NEXT TO, BESIDE

Closed hands with thumbs extended; R. hand twists from the wrist to the right, away from L. (R. hand only for NEXT, TURN).



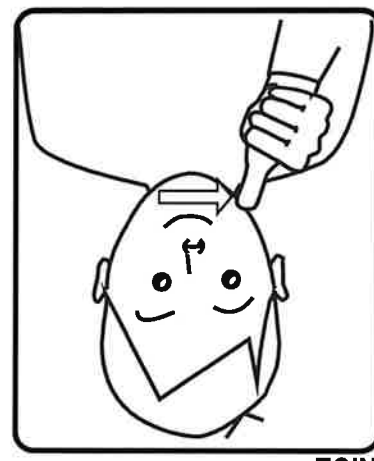
ON (physically), PUT ON

Back of R. flat hand is placed on back of L.



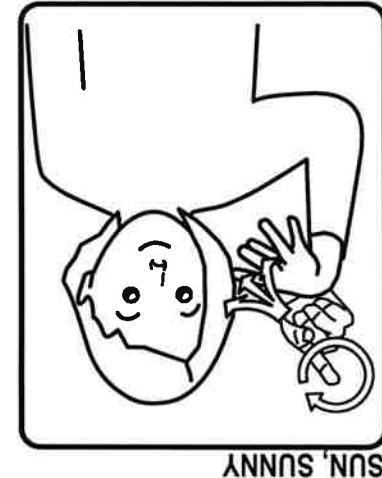
DOWN

Index finger points down and makes small downward movement. Also means THIS, HERE, DOWNSTAIRS (may repeat).



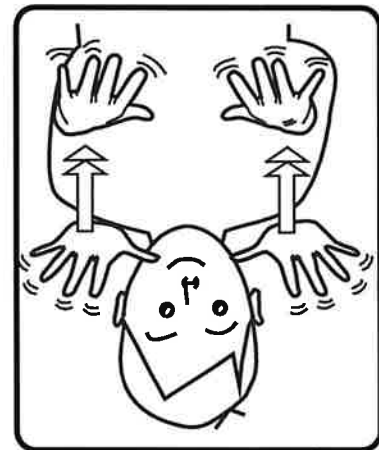
NICE

R. thumb moves across chin from left to right.



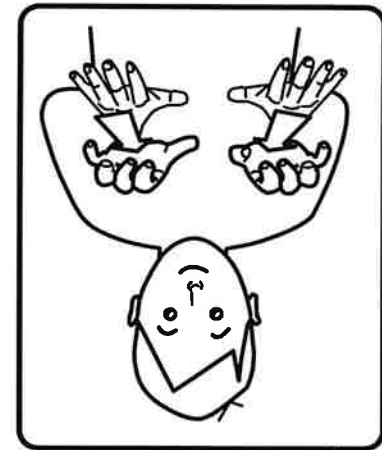
SUN, SUNNY

Index finger makes circle at head height, then changes to full hand opening with downward movement.



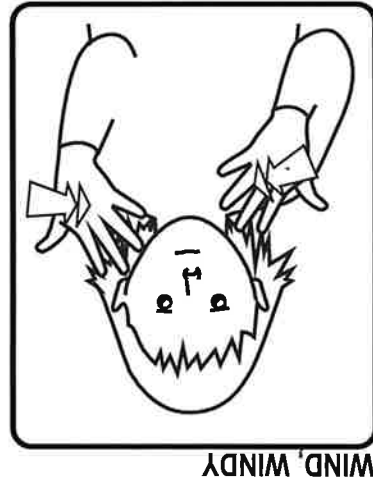
RAIN, DRIZZLE

Open hands make two movements down, the fingers may wiggle slightly, or may move with force.



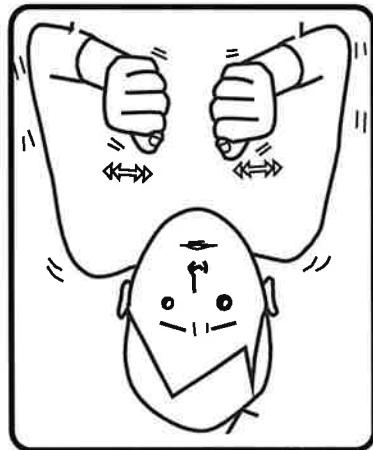
ICE, ICY

Palm down open hands held out in front of body, move back flexing to clawed hands. Also means FREEZE, FREEZING, FROZEN.



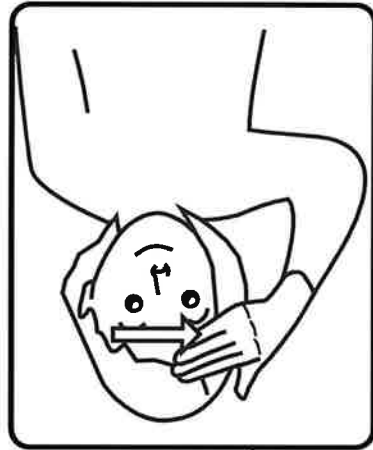
WIND, WINDY

Palm back open hands waff back to face several times.



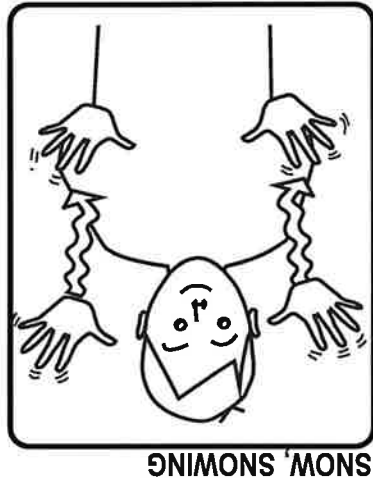
COLD, WINTER

Closed hands and elbows pull into body in shivering action, shoulders hunched.



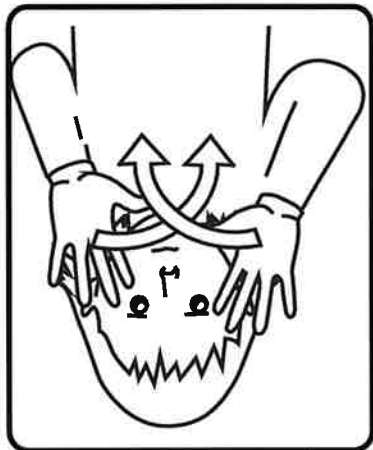
SUMMER, HOT WEATHER

Flat hand strokes left to right across forehead.



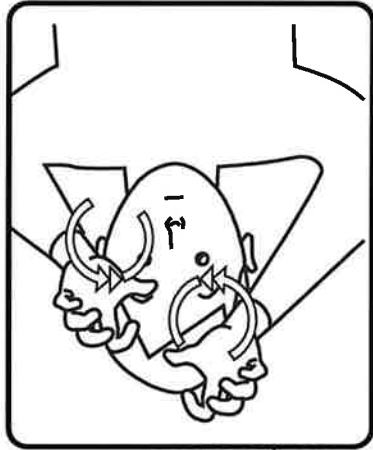
SNOW, SNOWING

Fingers wiggle as hands move down in small wavy movements.



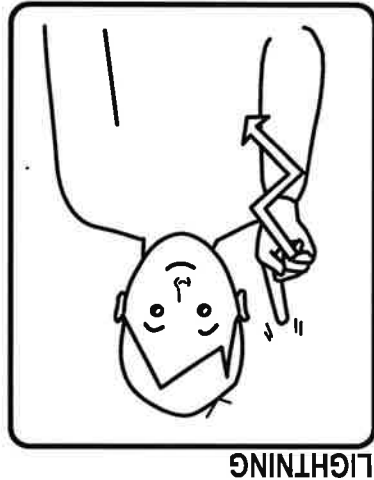
FOG, FOGGY

Palm forward open hands move down and cross over in front of face, eyes slightly squinted.



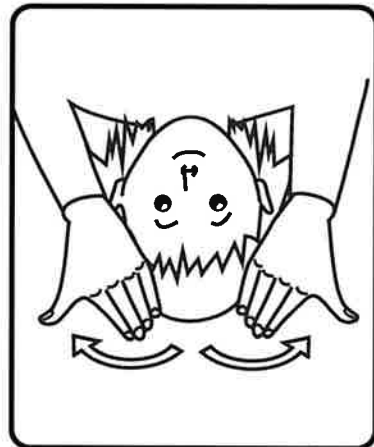
CLOUD, CLOUDY

Palm forward clawed hands make repeated alternate circling movements.



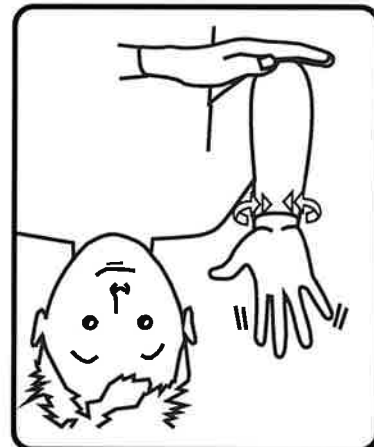
LIGHTNING

Palm forward index moves downward sharply in zigzag.



SKY, HEAVENS

Bent hands move apart in small arc over the head.



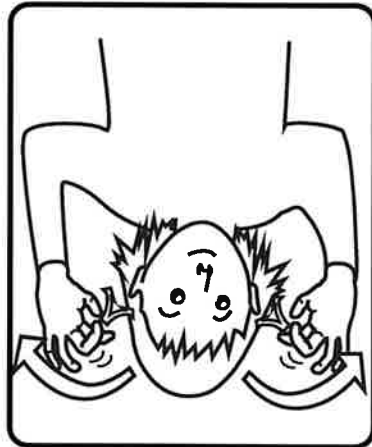
TREE

R. open hand upright and resting on L. hand, twists repeatedly from the wrist.



OUTSIDE

Bent hand makes two short forward movements.



STARS

Middle finger tips flick out from thumbs as hands move out in small arcs at head height.



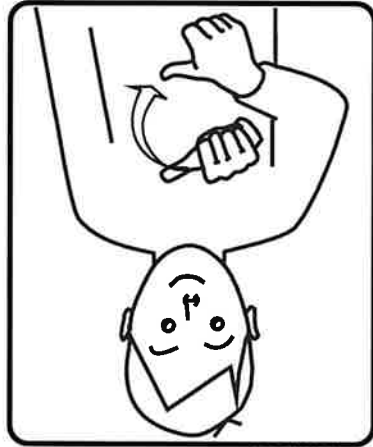
FLOWER

'O' (or punched) hand moves from side to side under nose, like sniffing a flower. For GARDEN, add sweep of palm down flat hand.



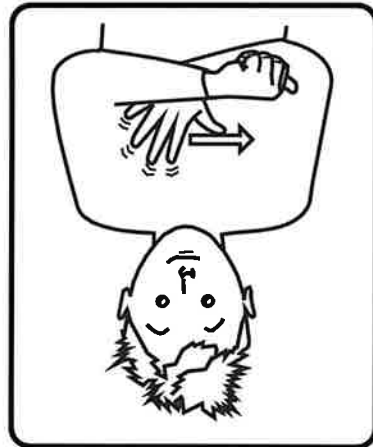
SEA, OCEAN, WATER

Palm down open hand moves sideways in wavy up and down motion. Can be both hands.



FARM/ER

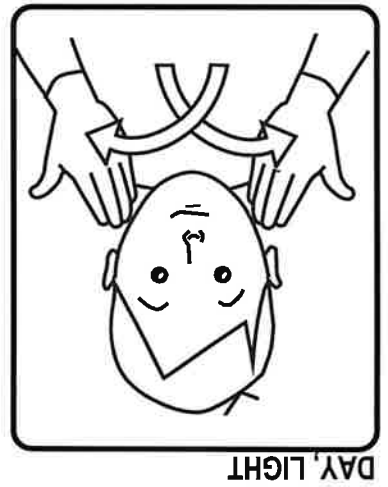
Closed hand, thumb out moves from chest in forward arcs to re-contact body. For FARM, add sideways sweep of palm down flat hand.



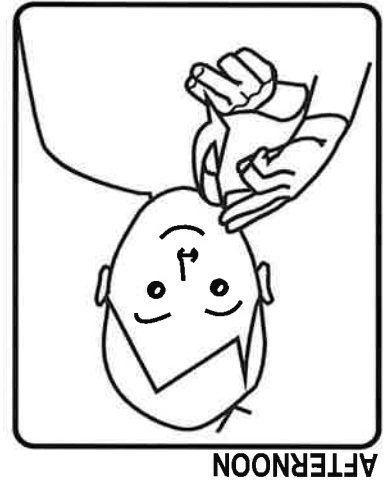
GRASS

Fingers of R. hand wiggle as they move along behind left forearm.

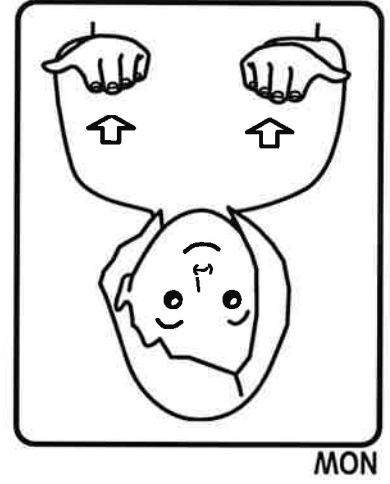
TIME/DAYS



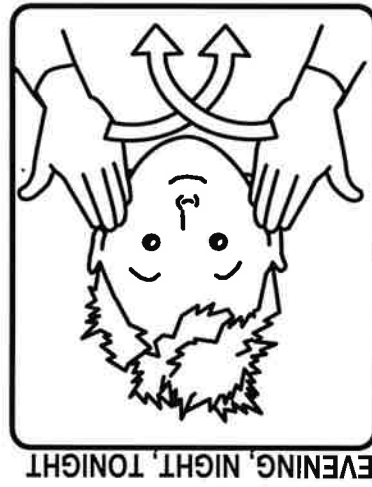
Palm back open hands start crossed and swing upwards and apart.



Tips of 'N' hand touch chin, then hand twists from wrist to point forwards.



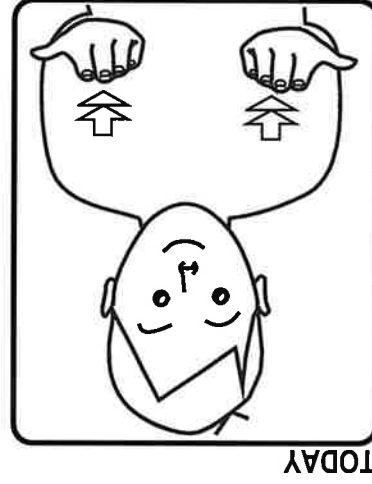
Palm up flat hands make single firm movement down.



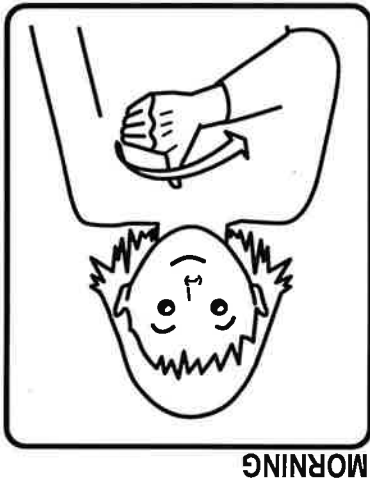
Palm back flat hands swing in/down to finish crossed.



Index finger on side of cheek twists back/down onto shoulder.



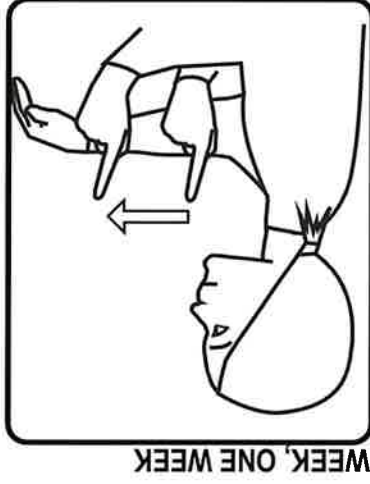
Palm up flat hands make two short movements down.



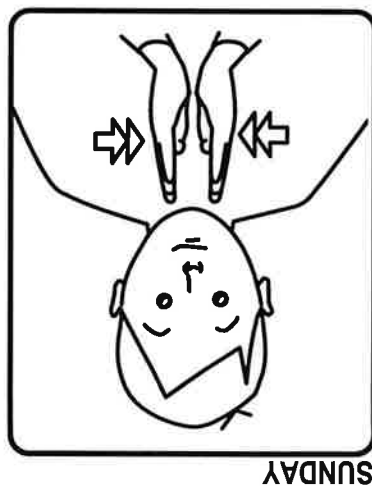
Finger tips of R. bent hand (with thumb up) touch left then right side of chest.



Index finger on side of cheek twists forward/down from the wrist to finish palm up.

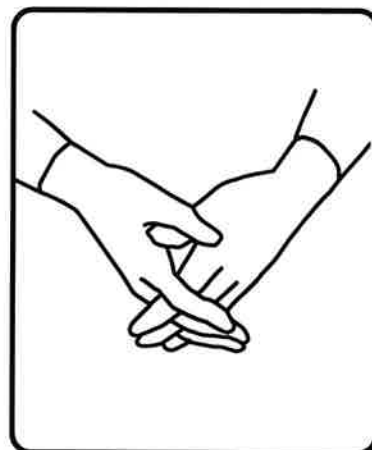


Extended index finger moves forward along left forearm. Two fingers extended for TWO WEEKS and so on.



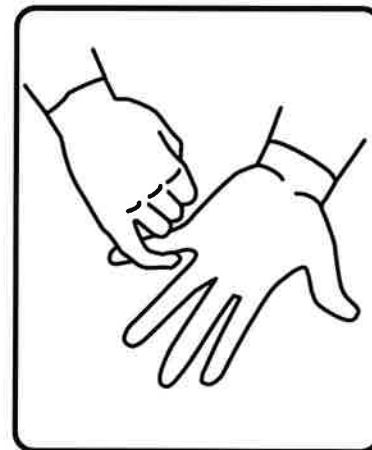
SUNDAY

Flat hands tap together twice. **Varies.** Without movement also means **PRAY/ER.**



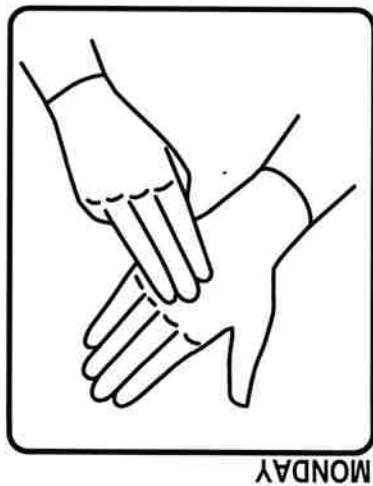
WEDNESDAY

Fingerpell initial 'W'. Followed by sign for 'DAY' (not in BSL).



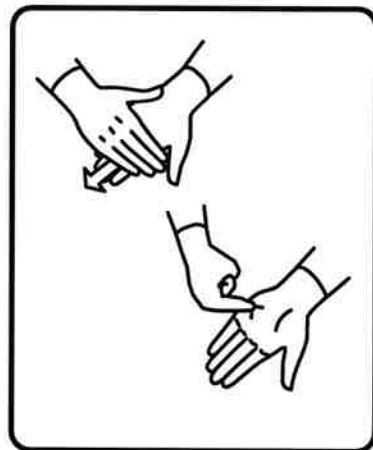
SATURDAY

Fingerpell initial 'S'. Followed by sign for 'DAY' (not in BSL).



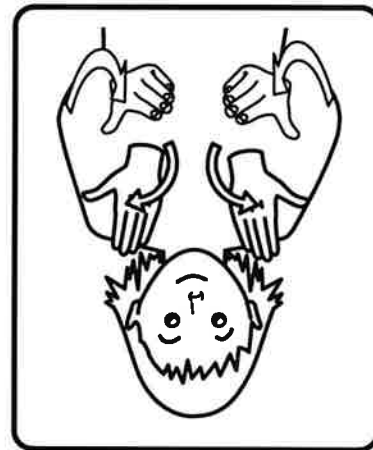
MONDAY

Fingerpell initial 'M'. Followed by sign for 'DAY' (not in BSL).



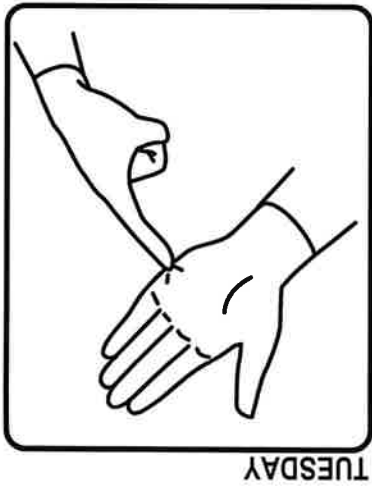
THURSDAY

Fingerpell 'TH'. Followed by sign for 'DAY' (not in BSL).



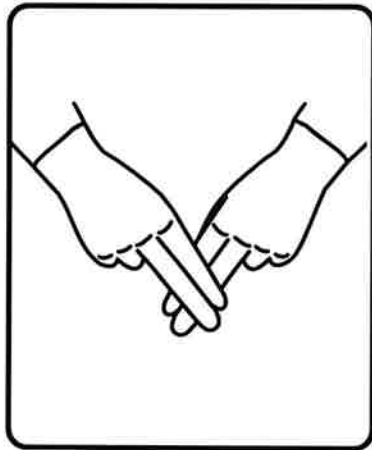
BIRTHDAY

Flat hands near sides of waist move forward/in and then upwards and apart.



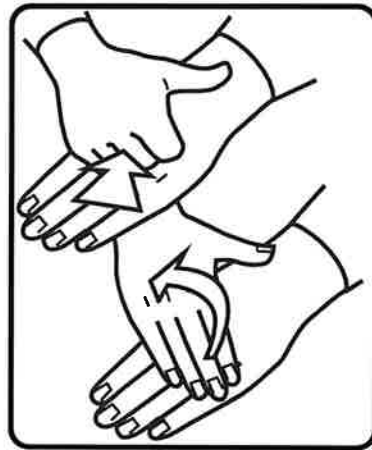
TUESDAY

Fingerpell initial 'T'. Followed by sign for 'DAY' (not in BSL).



FRIDAY

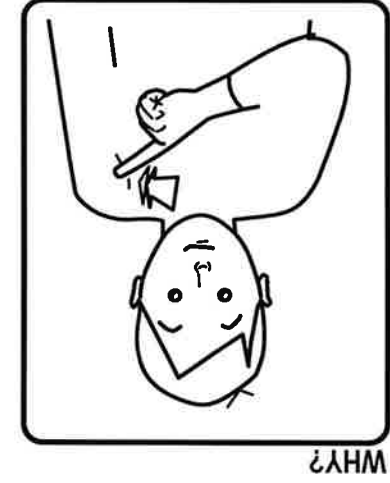
Fingerpell initial 'F'. Followed by sign for 'DAY' (not in BSL).



CHRISTMAS

R. hand brushes down across back of L. hand and contacts back of L. hand again.

QUESTIONS/LINK WORDS



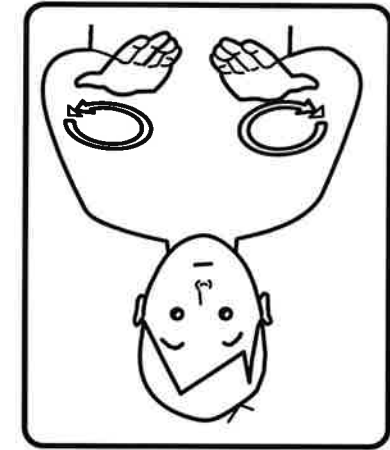
WHY?

Edge of R. index taps side of left upper chest twice, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



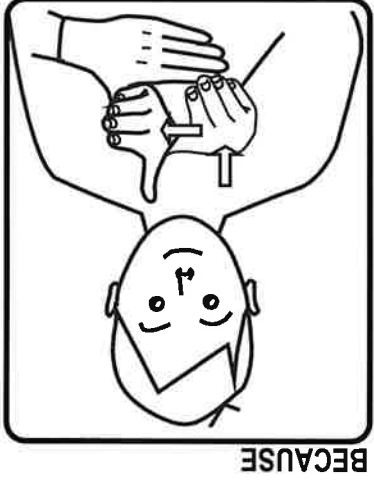
WHEN?

Fingers wiggle at side of face, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



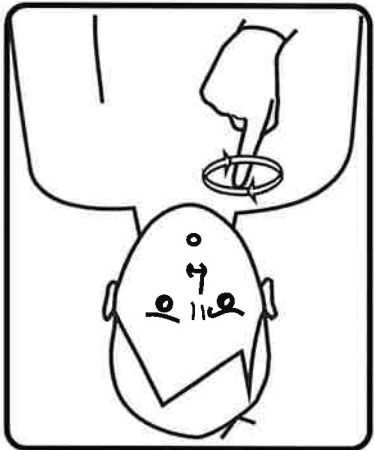
WHERE?

Palm up hands move in small outward circles, or hands may move in-out towards each other, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



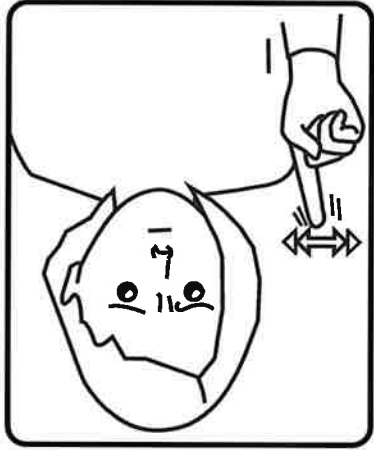
BECAUSE

R. flat hand contacts index edge of L. hand, then twists and moves left to touch inside of L. thumb.



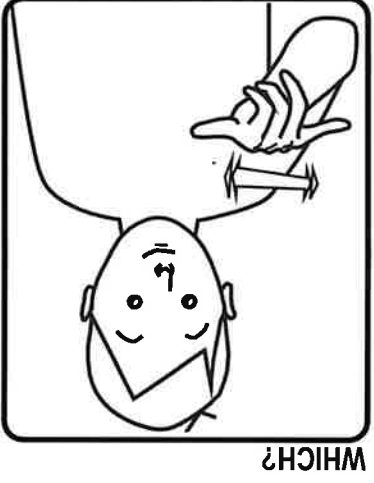
WHO?

Index finger makes small horizontal circles, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



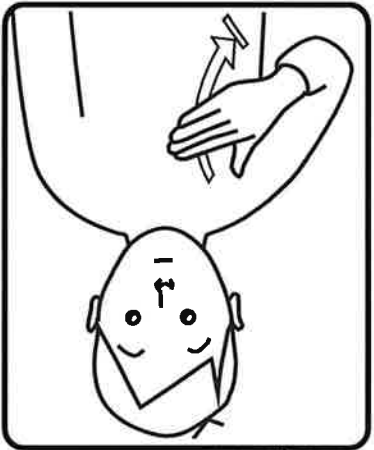
WHAT? WHAT FOR?

Palm forward index makes small side to side shaking movements, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



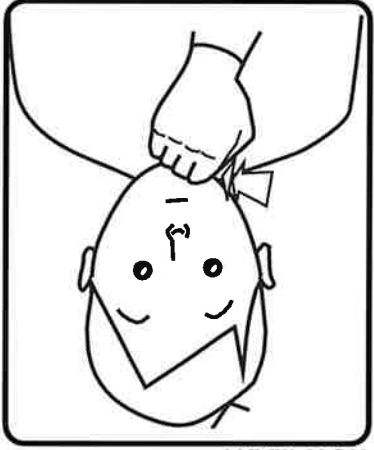
WHICH?

'Y' hand moves from side to side or between the objects or persons referred to, eyebrows raised or furrowed.



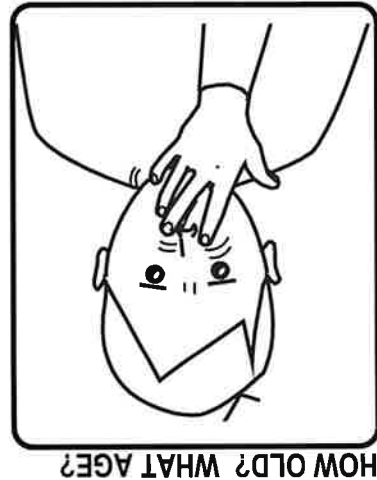
WANT, NEED

Flat hand brushes down side of chest twisting to palm down.



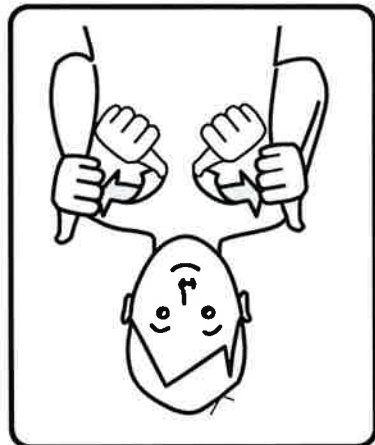
HOW MANY

Knuckles of closed hand tap chin twice. With raised eyebrows can also mean NUMBER, DATE, MATHS.



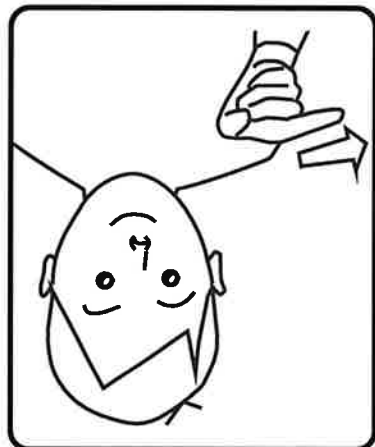
HOW OLD? WHAT AGE?

Fingers wiggle in front of nose. Eyebrows are raised or furrowed.



HOW ARE YOU?

Closed hands with thumbs up twist shaply over from palm down to palms facing.



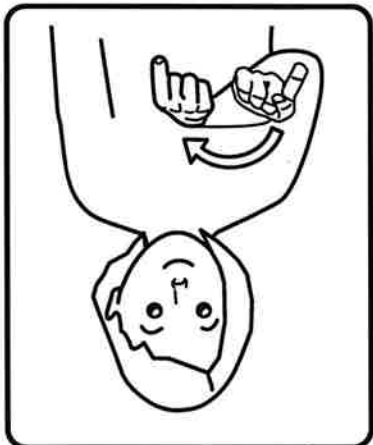
YOU

Index points with short movement towards referent (with eye gaze).



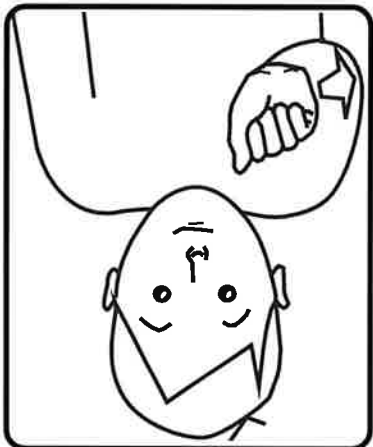
HOW MUCH

Hand held palm back with fingers wiggling. Eyebrows are raised or furrowed.



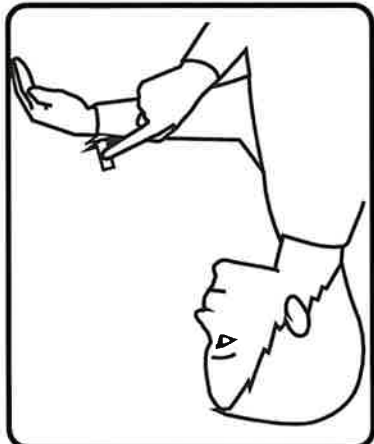
AND, IN ADDITION

Extended index finger flips up to palm down. This is not a BSL sign.



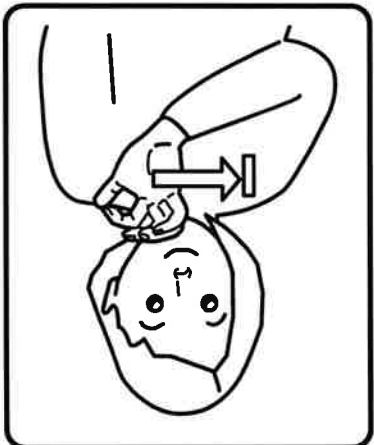
YOUR, YOURS

Palm forward closed hand is directed towards referent (with eye gaze).



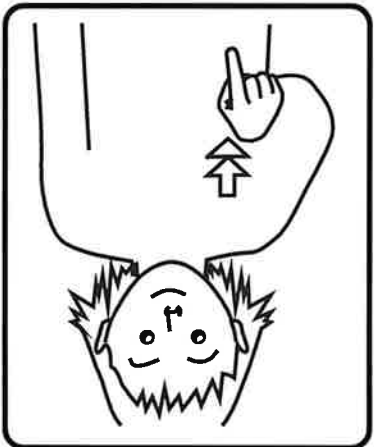
TIME, WHAT TIME?

R. index taps back of left wrist twice. With brows raised or furrowed means WHAT TIME?



THE

Palm forward 'O' hand moves to the right. This is not a BSL sign.



HERE, THIS

Index finger makes two short downward movements. Two means DOWNSTAIRS. Also hands can be used. Also

SOME SENTENCES TO PRACTISE SIGNING

Try practising some of these in a role play session. Take turns to be the child and think about how you would go about communicating your needs and also how you would respond as an adult. Remember you need to be modelling the signed and the spoken word in your response.

Try also to think about what words and signs you are using to communicate, for example the phrase '*do you want to play in the sand?*' could be reworded so that it doesn't just require a *yes* or *no* answer. '*Do you want to play in the sand or water?*' is better, since it gives a choice and thus provides an opportunity for the child to practise language. Then you need to think about what signs you will use - you will probably only sign *PLAY SAND* and *PLAY WATER* but you will say the full sentence.

SHORT PHRASES YOU MIGHT LIKE TO PRACTISE SIGNING AND SAYING

Good Listening	Good afternoon
Please get dressed	Good morning
Stand up	Where's your book
Stop	Where are your shoes
Please	Good work
Thank you	Good reading
Please sit here	Look at me
Look at the teacher	Look at this
Good sitting	Look here
Listen to the teacher	Good eating
Listen	Sit down
Sit here	

LONGER SENTENCES - SIGN KEY WORDS

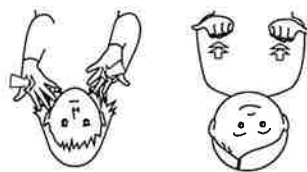
Which one do you want?	What do you want to eat?
Which ones are the same?	Why did this happen?
Who do you want to sit with?	Who do you want to play with?
Please put your things away.	Please eat up your dinner.
Come here now.	Chew up your
Sit down on your chair now.	Food/crisps/sandwiches.
Please walk slowly.	Get undressed for your bath please.
Come here quickly.	Hello, how are you today?
What do you want to do? This or that?	Do you want chips or mashed potato?

SENTENCES A CHILD MIGHT TRY TO COMMUNICATE

I like bananas.
I don't want carrots.
I'm hungry.
I like my teacher.
It is windy today.
I want some paper.
I like school.
My head is hurting.
I want to play outside.
Please play that music again.
I want to draw a picture.
I have broken my pencil.
Can I have a drink of
water/milk?
My hands are dirty.



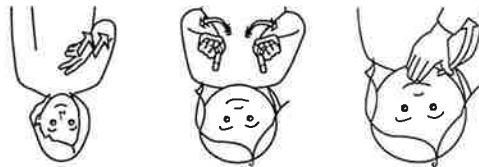
Today is windy.



I want some paper.



Please play that music again.



I want my dinner.

I want to go home.

I want you to do that again.

I am tired.

Help me.

I'm finished.

I want a turn.

Please may I have a biscuit?

I want my mummy.

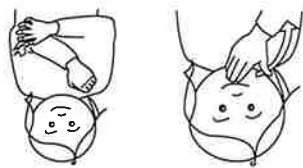
My daddy is at work.

My brother is at home.

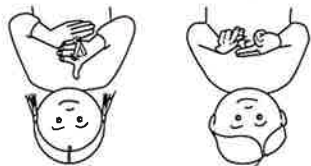
I want an apple.

My sister's name is Anne.

I don't like that it scares me.



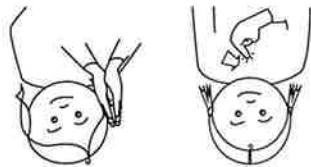
Please may I have a biscuit?



My daddy is at work.



Help me.



I'm tired.

EARLY LANGUAGE DEVELOPMENT ACTIVITIES

These activities are helpful in encouraging early communication skills.

- Try to avoid any distractions - turn off the TV and radio.
- Try to be as animated as possible and give lots of praise for any success.
- Continue for only as long as the child is interested.

Teach the signs to your child by demonstrating and by guiding their hands if needed. Children with Down syndrome usually pick up signs quite quickly.

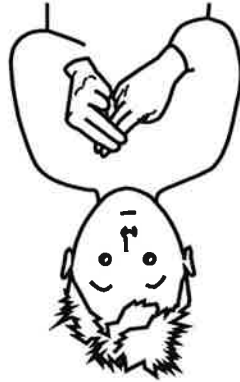
Don't worry if the child signs the word in their own way - for example, pats top of arm rather than elbow for *BISCUIT* - it's the communication that is important. You in turn will sign the sign correctly and say the spoken word loud and clear, firstly in isolation and then in a sentence eg. *BISCUIT?* Do you want a *BISCUIT* to *EAT*?

LIKE



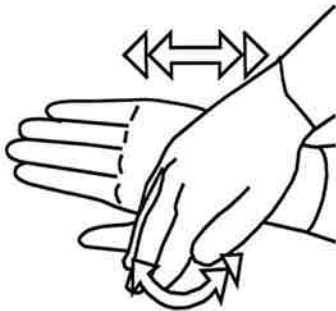
Flat hand taps on chest.

TOGETHER/WITH



R. hand fingers grasp L.

SHARE



Hands waggle to and fro, R. edge rests on L.

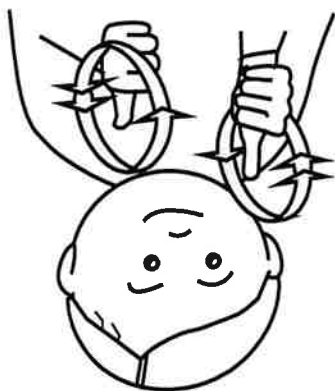
Sign key words and give lots of encouragement, eg. *Do you LIKE that?* - *let's do it TOGETHER* - *shall we SHARE it?*

Remember to always say the words as you sign. Talk to your child and/or sing to them all the time - it's easy to forget to do this when a child is not talking - don't let this stop you!

ROLL THE BALL - sit on the floor with a medium sized ball, facing your child. Say and sign the child's name (first letter), let's call the child SAM, signed 'S', wait until he makes eye contact and then roll the ball to him.

Encourage the child to roll the ball back - say and sign *BALL PLEASE* - be as animated as possible - sign and say *THANK YOU* and *WELL DONE!* when the ball is returned.

A sibling or partner could be employed to demonstrate the object of the game and to make it more fun! Encourage the child to say/sign *PLEASE* or *BALL PLEASE* before you to return the ball to him/her.



WELL DONE!

POST THE BALL - make a hole in the bottom of a shoebox or similar and turn it upside down. Take a small ball, attract the child's attention *LOOK SAM!* and post the ball through the hole. Say/sign *WHERE'S the BALL?* Lift the box and act surprised saying *HERE it is!*

Now it's Sam's turn - say *WHO'S NEXT?* and *SAM'S TURN*, signing 'S' and encourage him to take the ball and post it; guide his hand if necessary.

Say/sign *WHERE'S the BALL?* and help find it if necessary - *HERE it is!* Say/sign *MUMMY'S* (or *DADDY'S!*) *TURN NOW* and repeat the activity.



TURN

BLOW BUBBLES - this is great fun. Initially this activity can be used along the lines of the ball activity above, waiting until the child responds to their name before you blow the bubbles. Blow the bubbles so that the child has to move their head to follow them.

As the child develops the aim is for them to blow their own bubbles.

This activity helps the child to become more aware of their mouth and gain muscle control. Similarly blow through straws or blow feathers - don't worry if your child can't do it at first - it's good fun!



BLOW BUBBLES

READ

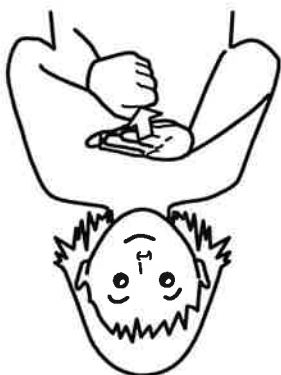
READ BOOKS with your child. Books with 1 - 4 words on each page are ideal. Choose familiar repetitive stories. You can make your own books using photos of family and friends and the child's own toys if you wish. Sign key words as you read.

SNACK TIME offers a wonderful opportunity to stimulate communication development.

Sit your child to the table and offer them a drink - you can simply say and sign *DRINK*? Guide the child's hand in the *DRINK* sign and then give them the cup. Progress to *DRINK PLEASE* and *THANK YOU* - similarly with crisps, fruit, cereal, or biscuits etc. depending on what your child enjoys.

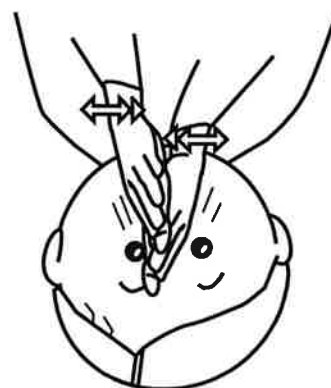
Give small amounts at a time so they have to keep asking - it is easier to encourage them to ask for something that they really want!

Introduce the concept and sign of *MORE* - this is a simple but very useful word.

MORE

To encourage **LISTENING SKILLS** it is useful (and fun) to hide a favourite toy which makes a sound - music box etc. beneath a cloth next to you. Show the child what you are doing at first - leave a bit showing or help the child to find it. Say and sign *WHERE IS IT?*

Once the child gets the idea you can hide the toy when the child isn't looking and progress to hiding it behind furniture or in another room etc.

HIDE

IN THE KITCHEN - take your child into the kitchen with you while you are preparing food or washing or emptying the washing machine and so on. Talk (or sing!) about what you are doing - name items - vegetables or clothing etc. Give them an object to play with such as a potato to roll, a sock or a spoon. Talk about the item.

KITCHEN

There are lots of opportunities for conversation when playing with **SMALL**

WORLD i.e. doll's house, farmyard etc.

Talk about what the dolls are doing - eating, going to bed etc. - Say and sign the names of animals and the noises that they make - a good cue to sing 'Old McDonald'! Children seem to be able to focus on small world better than the real world at times.

Old McDonald



SING lots of action songs and songs with signs. Add signs to nursery rhymes - don't worry if the existing gestures to some songs are not signs, eg. Incy Wincy Spider, the gestures are still making the song visual and helping the child to join in. See some of the signing sources in Recommended Resources for some good ideas, and also check out the interactive ebooks from the Let's Sign series.

Some other suggested songs are;

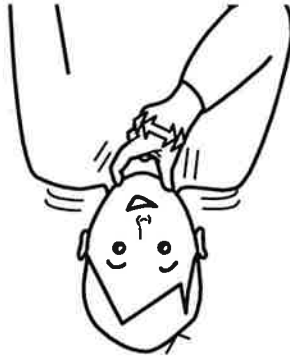
Wind a bobbin up
Incy wincy spider
Humpty Dumpty
Mum and dad and uncle John
The wheels on the bus
Row, row, row your boat
Round and round the garden like a teddy bear
This little piggy
* Criss cross apple sauce

* Words overleaf

And later:

Five little ducks went swimming one day
Five currant buns in a bakers shop
Five little speckled frogs
Five fat sausages sizzling in a pan
Miss Polly had a dolly

Action songs like these are a wonderful opportunity for a *CUDGLE*, a *LAUGH* and why not finish it all off with a *DANCE*!

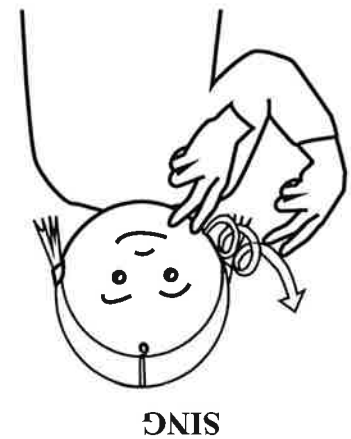


and down.

As you say *and we all shiver, we all shiver* - jiggle them from side to side, up
As you say *a tight squeeze* - wrap your arms around them and squeeze them.
As you say *a cool breeze* - blow on the back of their neck.
As you say *in your hair* - tickle in their hair.
As you say *spiders there* - tickle under their right arm.
As you say *spiders here* - tickle under their left arm.
As you say *spider crawling up your back* - scurry your fingers up their back.
hand.
As you say *Apple Sauce* - rub round and round on their back with the flat of your
As you say *Criss Cross* - draw a cross on their back with your pointing finger.
Sit your child on your knee with their back towards you and;

* Criss Cross Apple Sauce - for babies on knees.

SING as well as talk to your child as much as possible. We have found singing can be a great help when dressing/undressing/doing something they don't particularly want to do/are uncertain about. If you sing anything that comes into your head eg. 'this is the way we put on your sock' (to the tune of *Here we go round the mulberry bush*) it seems to work and it also helps to stop you from getting stressed out with it all!



SING

Start by singing with your child on your knee helping them to sign it. Then sit them opposite you and let them watch you. If you have a large mirror do it in front of a mirror.